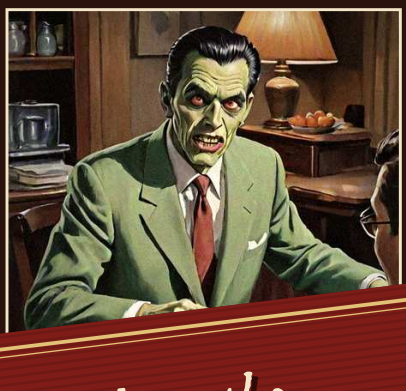
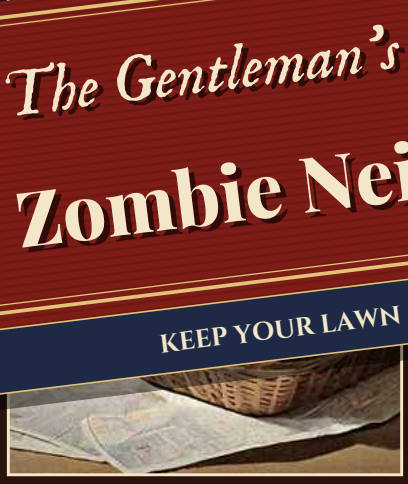
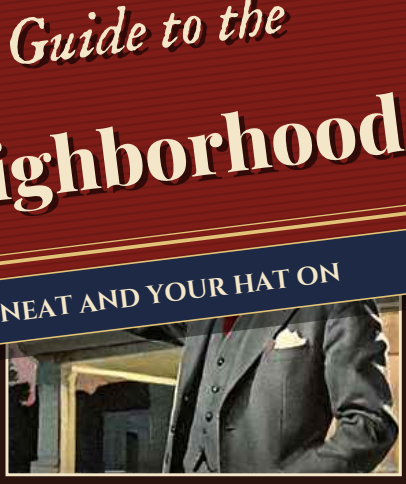









The Gentleman's Guide to the Zombie Neighborhood

KEEP YOUR LAWN NEAT AND YOUR HAT ON

NEIGHBORLY
60
SKILLS

THE GENTLEMAN'S GUIDE TO THE ZOMBIE NEIGHBORHOOD



EX LIBRIS

This book belongs to

_____
__

and their household, _____

The Gentleman's Guide to the

ZOMBIE NEIGHBORHOOD

60 Essential Skills for Keeping Up Appearances When Half the Block Has Turned

AN ILLUSTRATED HANDBOOK OF GOOD MANNERS FOR A STREET THAT HAS TURNED

FUN BOOKS · HOME EDITION · 2026

The Gentleman's Guide to the Zombie Neighborhood: 60 Essential Skills for Keeping Up Appearances When Half the Block Has Turned. Fun Books Home Edition, 2026.

Written and illustrated as an original work. The text and pictures in this book were created from scratch for this edition and are not copied from any other publication.

Please read before using this book. This is a work of good-natured humor. Every family, neighbor, milkman, barber and zombie in it is made up, and any resemblance to your own neighbors is a coincidence, however green they look on a Monday. Please do not climb onto roofs, trim hedges with people in them or feed anyone cauliflower against their will. Do try the good manners.

Printing tips. This book is laid out on US Letter (8.5 x 11 in) pages. Print double-sided, “flip on long edge”, at 100% scale. For a book that lies flat on the kitchen table, ask a copy shop for spiral or comb binding with a clear front and a heavy back cover.

Made with care for everyone who has ever waved at a neighbor and got a groan back.

For every gentleman who kept his lawn neat
when the neighborhood turned.

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INTRODUCTION

How to use this book

There was a time, not so long ago, when the worst thing that could happen on an American street was crabgrass. Then Mr. Hale next door stopped saying good morning and started saying "Uuuurgh", the milkman began leaving the bottles on the wrong porch and the bridge club came back from the church social looking a little green. Half the block has turned.

Most gentlemen are not ready. Nobody teaches neighborly manners for the undead at school. The old etiquette books say nothing about mowing around a neighbor who will not move, passing the gravy to a man with no aim or getting the whole street off your lawn when you light the barbecue. This book is here to help.

What you'll find inside. Sixty skills in nine chapters, each on a single page laid out the same way: a picture for every step, a short explanation of why it matters, a materials panel with what you'll need, and a notes panel with tips and the most important warnings. Colored tabs on the edge of every page tell you which chapter you're in, so you can find the right page quickly, even while Mrs. Pettibone is asleep on your porch swing.

How to use it. Don't wait for the whole block to turn. Read the first chapter tonight. Buy two heads of cauliflower. Put a waltz record by the front door. Tuck a pocket mirror into your jacket. Each skill you practice now is one less surprise when Mr. Hale wanders into the petunias.

Start with the basics. If your street has already turned, begin with Chapter 1 (the signs), mowing in Chapter 2, the hat-tip in Chapter 3 and the cauliflower in Chapter 4. Those four alone will put your household well ahead of the Hendersons, who tried to explain the situation to the Garden Club and have not won Yard of the Month since.

The appendix at the back gathers the charts and checklists you'll reach for most: a field guide to the neighbors, a chart of what to serve whom, household remedies for neighborly mishaps, handy conversions, checklists, a household card, a glossary, and a log for the skills your household has mastered.

A word on kindness. The turned neighbors are not wicked. They are slow, a little groany and very fond of soft soil, rather like a large and devoted dog. Watch for the boxes marked **Important**, and remember that the best defense in any neighborhood is a neat lawn, a straight bow tie and a kind word for everyone, groaning or not.

CHAPTERS AT A GLANCE

CHAPTER	WHAT IT COVERS	SKILLS
1. There Goes the Neighborhood	Recognizing the signs that the folks next door have turned	6
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CHAPTER ONE

1

THERE GOES THE NEIGHBORHOOD

Recognizing the signs that the folks next door have turned



It came on gradually, the way crabgrass does. First Mr. Hale next door stopped saying 'Good morning' and started saying 'Uuuurgh'. Then the milkman began leaving our bottles on the wrong porch, and the bridge club came back from the church social looking a little green. Half the block has turned. A gentleman does not panic. He straightens his bow tie, notices the signs early and carries on being a good neighbor. This chapter shows him how.

IN THIS CHAPTER

01 Noticing That Mr. Hale Has Turned
02 The Milkman Who Only Says 'Brains'
03 Telling a Zombie From a Neighbor Before Coffee
04 When the Bridge Club Comes Back Different
05 Taking the Morning Paper From a Zombie Paperboy
06 Breaking the News to the Family Over Supper

HOW TO

NOTICING THAT MR. HALE HAS TURNED

SKILL 01 · THERE GOES THE NEIGHBORHOOD · 5 MINUTES · EASY

MATERIALS

- A cup of coffee



- Your reading glasses



- A pencil and notepad



- The morning newspaper



- Your good manners



Mr. Hale has lived next door for eleven years. He is a steady fellow, fond of his lawn and his pipe. Lately, however, he has been walking into the hedge, groaning at the mailbox and wearing the same rumpled suit for nine days running. A gentleman notices these things, and remains polite.

1



Say Good Morning

Call a cheerful 'Good morning, Hale!' over the fence. If he answers 'Uuuurgh', make a note.

2



Look at His Complexion

A healthy neighbor is pink. A turned neighbor is the color of pea soup.

3

Watch How He Walks

Turned neighbors shuffle and drag one foot. Do not confuse this with Monday.



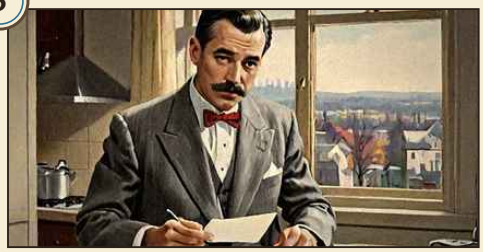
4



Check His Lawn

Mr. Hale would never let his grass grow past an inch. Today it is up to his knees.

5



Write It Down

Keep a short log. 'Tuesday: groaned at the mailbox. Wednesday: groaned at the mailbox again.'

6



Remain Neighborly

Turned or not, he is still Mr. Hale. Wave and carry on.

NOTES

Turned neighbors keep their old habits. If Mr. Hale always fetched his paper at seven, he will still shuffle out at seven. Set your watch by him.

IMPORTANT

Never sneak up behind a turned neighbor and say 'Boo'. He has heard it all before, and he will want a hug.

HOW TO

THE MILKMAN WHO ONLY SAYS 'BRAINS'

SKILL 02 · THERE GOES THE NEIGHBORHOOD · 10 MINUTES · EASY

Our milkman, Mr. Doyle, is as punctual as ever. He arrives at six sharp with the milk, the cream and the butter. The difference is that he now groans 'Braaains' instead of 'Morning, ma'am', and he has started leaving the bottles on the wrong porch.

1



Open the Door at Six

He will be on the step, as always. Smile. He means well.

2



Listen to the Order

If he says 'Braaains', he means 'Good morning'. If he says it twice, he means 'Cream today?'

3



Leave a Clear Note

Write in big letters: 'Two quarts, please. No brains.' Prop it in an empty bottle.

MATERIALS



Two quart bottles of milk



A note for the milkman



Your slippers



A tip in an envelope



A cheerful smile

4



Look Next Door

If the bottles are missing, check the Hales' porch. He has been confused about doorsteps lately.

5



Fetch Them Back

Pop over in your slippers and carry them home. Wave to Mr. Hale on the way.

NOTES

A zombie milkman never forgets his route. He may forget his trousers, but he never forgets his route.

IMPORTANT

Do not order the cottage cheese. He thinks it is something else entirely, and he gets very excited.



6 *Tip Him at Christmas*

He still delivers in all weather. That deserves an envelope.

HOW TO

TELLING A ZOMBIE FROM A NEIGHBOR BEFORE COFFEE

SKILL 03 · THERE GOES THE NEIGHBORHOOD · 5 MINUTES · MEDIUM

MATERIALS

- A strong cup of coffee



- Your bathrobe



- Your slippers



- The morning newspaper

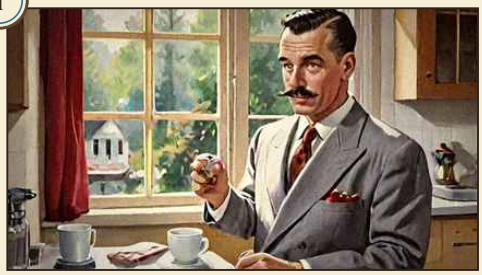


- A doughnut



At half past six in the morning, everyone on the block shuffles. Everyone groans. Everyone is a little pale. It is very easy to mistake an ordinary sleepy neighbor for a zombie, and it is very embarrassing to offer Mr. Peabody a brain when all he wanted was the sports page.

1



Drink Your Own Coffee First

Before you judge anyone else, make sure you are not the one shuffling.

2



Look for a Bathrobe

A neighbor in a bathrobe is probably just tired. Zombies dress for the office.

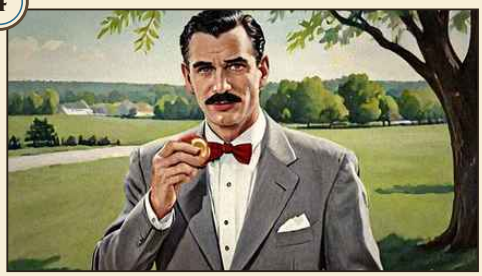
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Check the Color

Pale is sleepy. Pale green is something else.



4



Offer a Doughnut

A neighbor takes the doughnut. A zombie sniffs it, groans and looks at your head.

5



Listen to the Groan

A sleepy groan goes down at the end. A zombie groan goes up, like a question.

6



Say Good Morning Anyway

Either way, good manners never hurt. Tip your coffee cup and go inside.

NOTES

On Monday mornings, wait until eight before deciding anyone has turned. Monday makes zombies of us all.

IMPORTANT

Do not test a neighbor by poking him with the rake. Mr. Peabody is still upset about it.

HOW TO

WHEN THE BRIDGE CLUB COMES BACK DIFFERENT

SKILL 04 · THERE GOES THE NEIGHBORHOOD · 1 AFTERNOON · MEDIUM

The Tuesday bridge club went to the church social and came back a little green. Mrs. Pettibone still wears her curlers and still bids four hearts on every hand. Now she groans while she does it and tries to eat the score pad.

1



Set Up the Card Table

A clean lace cloth, four chairs and the good teacups. Standards matter.

2



Greet Mrs. Pettibone

She is still Mrs. Pettibone. Ask after her sciatica.

3



Deal Slowly

Turned players are slow to pick up their cards. Be patient. So is Mrs. Abernathy, and she is alive.

MATERIALS


A deck of cards


A score pad and pencil


A plate of finger sandwiches


A pot of tea


A lace tablecloth

4



Keep the Score Pad Away From Her

She thinks it is a cracker. Hold it on your lap.

5



Serve the Sandwiches

Cucumber for the living, cauliflower for the rest.

NOTES

Turned bridge players never bluff. If Mrs. Pettibone groans twice, she has the queen of spades.

IMPORTANT

Keep your fingers clear of the sandwich tray while she is reaching. She has no aim.



6 *Let Her Win One Hand*

It is only polite, and she groans so happily.

HOW TO

TAKING THE MORNING PAPER FROM A ZOMBIE PAPERBOY

SKILL 05 · THERE GOES THE NEIGHBORHOOD · 5 MINUTES · EASY

MATERIALS

- A baseball glove



- Your reading glasses



- A dime for the boy



- A sturdy porch chair



- Your Sunday hat



Young Tommy Briggs still delivers the Gazette every morning. He has a fine throwing arm, which is the trouble. Since he turned, he throws the paper at whatever moves, and Grandfather moves slowly but he does move.

1



Sit on the Porch at Seven

Be in your chair before he comes round the corner.

2



Put On the Glove

A baseball glove saves the windows and your spectacles.

3

Watch for Him

He comes up the street with his bag over his shoulder, groaning the headlines.



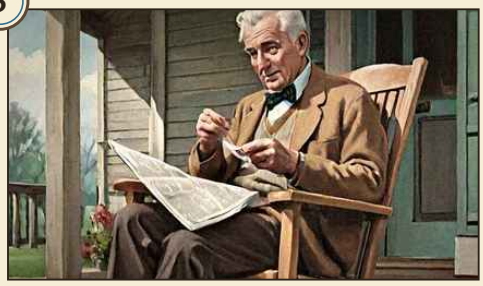
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Hold Very Still

He throws at movement. Freeze like a garden gnome.

5



Read the Headlines

One clean catch, then sit and read. Do not show off.

6



Pay the Boy

A dime on the porch rail at the end of the week. He still saves up for a bicycle.

NOTES

If you would rather not catch, leave a pillow on the top step. He always aims for the pillow.

IMPORTANT

Never throw the paper back. He thinks it is a game, and he will be there all morning.

HOW TO

BREAKING THE NEWS TO THE FAMILY OVER SUPPER

SKILL 06 · THERE GOES THE NEIGHBORHOOD · 20 MINUTES · MEDIUM

Sooner or later, the head of the household must sit the family down and explain that half the block has turned. The best time is supper, the best place is the dining table and the best tool is a calm voice and a good pot roast.

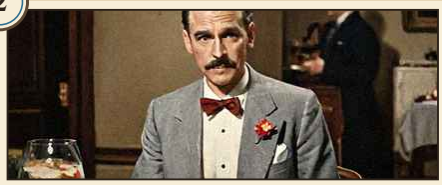
1



Wait for the Pot Roast

Never deliver big news on an empty stomach.

2



Clear Your Throat

A gentleman clears his throat before important news. It signals 'listen'.

3



Explain It Simply

'The Hales have turned. So have the Pettibones. The milkman, too.'

MATERIALS


A pot roast


A pitcher of milk


Your calm voice


A map of the block


Dessert (for afterward)

4



Show Them the Map

Mark the turned houses in green pencil. It helps the children understand.

5



Answer Questions

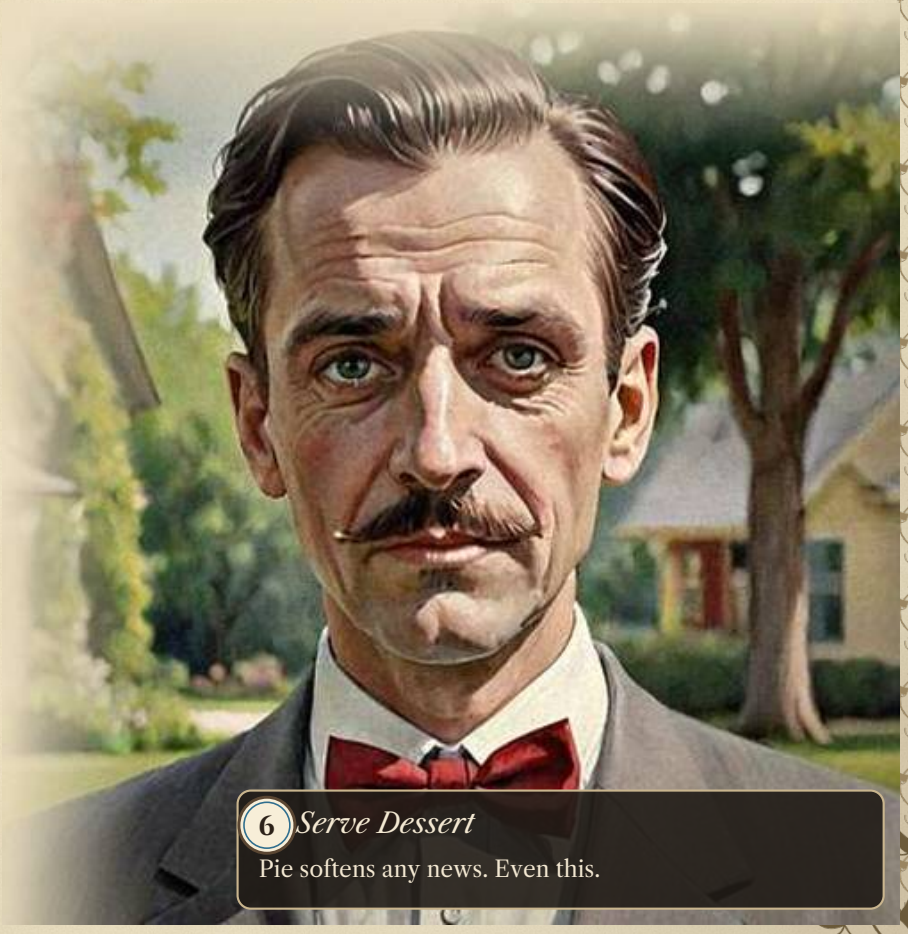
Junior will ask if he still has to mow the lawn. Yes.

NOTES

Keep the news short and the pie large. Families take things better with whipped cream.

IMPORTANT

Do not let Grandfather tell the story about the 1938 incident. Not at supper.



6 ### *Serve Dessert*

Pie softens any news. Even this.

CHAPTER TWO

2

THE LAWN MUST GO ON

Keeping the yard in order while the neighbors wander across it



A gentleman's lawn is his calling card. It says 'Here lives a man of order.' The arrival of the undead does not change this. If anything, it raises the stakes, because nothing makes the whole street look worse than a zombie standing in the petunias. This chapter covers mowing, hedging, raking and the dignified defense of the flower bed, so that yours remains the finest lawn on the block, whoever happens to be shuffling across it.

IN THIS CHAPTER

07 Mowing Around a Zombie Who Will Not Move
08 Keeping Zombies Off the Petunias
09 Trimming the Hedge When Someone Is Stuck in It
10 Sprinkler Etiquette for the Shambling
11 Raking Leaves With Help You Did Not Ask For
12 Winning Yard of the Month Anyway
13 Fixing the Picket Fence (Again)

HOW TO

MOWING AROUND A ZOMBIE WHO WILL NOT MOVE

SKILL 07 · THE LAWN MUST GO ON · 1 HOUR · MEDIUM

Saturday is mowing day, rain or shine, undead or not. The trouble is that Mr. Hale wandered onto your lawn on Thursday and has been standing in the middle of it ever since, staring at the birdbath. He will not be hurried. You will have to mow around him.

1



Survey the Lawn

Stand on the porch and see where he is. Plan your rows.

2



Greet Him Politely

'Morning, Hale. Mind if I mow?' He will not mind. He will not answer either.

3

Mow in Neat Rows

Straight stripes, as always. When you reach him, go around.



4



Mind His Shoes

Leave a polite six inches. He has only the one pair.

5



Trim the Ring by Hand

The circle of grass around him needs the hand shears. Kneel neatly.

6



Admire the Stripes

A good lawn, with a zombie in the middle like a sundial. Rather handsome.

NOTES

A zombie on the lawn makes an excellent sundial. At noon his shadow is directly under him.

IMPORTANT

Never use the power mower near a neighbor's feet. Use the push mower and go slowly.

MATERIALS

- A push lawn mower



- A pair of work gloves



- A straw hat



- A glass of lemonade



- A garden rake



HOW TO

KEEPING ZOMBIES OFF THE PETUNIAS

SKILL 08 · THE LAWN MUST GO ON · 1 AFTERNOON · MEDIUM

Grandmother's petunias won a ribbon at the county fair three years running. The zombies do not mean any harm. They simply like to stand in soft soil, and the flower bed is the softest soil on the street.

MATERIALS


A packet of petunia seeds


A watering can


A garden trowel


A ball of string


Little wooden stakes

1



Water the Bed

Early, before the shufflers are up.

2



Put Up a Little Fence

String and stakes. It will not stop them, but it tells them you mean it.

3



Spot the Intruder

If you see a pink curler among the pink petunias, look closer.

4



Lead Her Out Gently

Take her by the elbow and say 'This way, dear.' She will come.

5



Replant the Flattened Ones

Petunias are forgiving. So is Grandmother, eventually.



6 ### *Put a Chair Out for Them*

A garden chair by the gate gives them somewhere else to stand. They like a chair.

NOTES

Zombies are drawn to anything soft. A pile of grass clippings by the street keeps them busy for hours.

IMPORTANT

Never use the hose on a visitor. It only makes them groan louder and puts out the pipe of anyone nearby.

HOW TO

TRIMMING THE HEDGE WHEN SOMEONE IS STUCK IN IT

SKILL 09 · THE LAWN MUST GO ON · 1 HOUR · HARD

Mr. Hale walks into the hedge most evenings. Usually he backs out again. On Tuesday he did not. He is stuck in the boxwood up to his shoulders, groaning gently, and the hedge needs trimming before the garden club comes round.

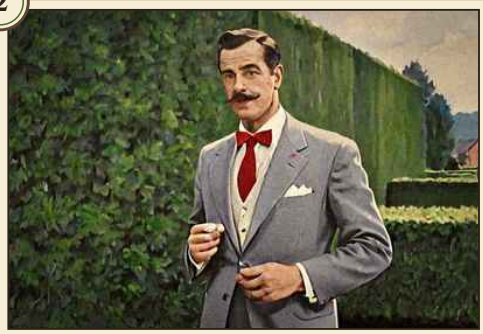
1



Assess the Hedge

Walk the length of it and look for a brown suit. That is Mr. Hale, wandering in for the evening.

2



Say Hello First

He is in there. A greeting is only polite.

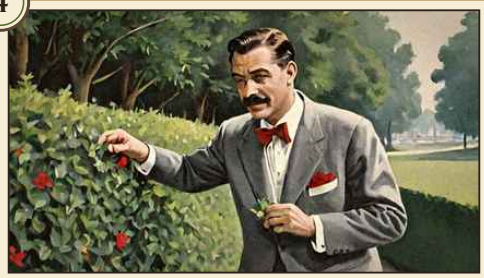
3

Trim Around His Head

Neat and level. Leave a tidy little doorway around him.



4



Ease Him Out Backward

Gently, by the coat tails. Boxwood lets go if you are patient.

5



Brush Him Off

Pick the leaves from his lapels. He has a reputation too.

6



Finish the Top Level

Run a string line and clip along it. Straight as a ruler.

NOTES

Leave a small gap in the hedge at zombie height. They will use it like a door and stop walking into the boxwood.

IMPORTANT

Never trim the hedge with electric clippers while anyone is inside it. Use hand shears and talk the whole time.

MATERIALS

- Hedge clippers



- A stepladder



- Work gloves



- A string line



- A bushel basket for clippings



HOW TO

SPRINKLER ETIQUETTE FOR THE SHAMBLING

SKILL 10 · THE LAWN MUST GO ON · 30 MINUTES · EASY

Junior's job is the sprinkler. It is an important job. Zombies love the sprinkler. They stand in it with their mouths open for hours, and if nobody moves the sprinkler, the whole front yard turns into a swamp with three groaning neighbors in it.

MATERIALS


A lawn sprinkler


A garden hose


A wristwatch


A beach towel


A pair of rubber boots

1



Set Out the Sprinkler

In the middle of the lawn, hose straight, no kinks.

2



Turn It On

Quarter turn at the tap. Watch the arc.

3



Count the Visitors

One, two, three neighbors standing in the spray. That is the limit.

4



Move It Every Twenty Minutes

Grass needs water evenly. So do the visitors, apparently.

5



Turn It Off at Supper

They will groan. That is how they say thank you.



6 *Hand Out Towels*

A gentleman's son offers a towel. Leave it on the fence.

NOTES

On hot days, set the sprinkler at the far corner of the yard. The zombies will gather there and leave the porch steps clear.

IMPORTANT

Never point the sprinkler at the house next door. The Hales left their windows open in 1956 and never closed them.

HOW TO

RAKING LEAVES WITH HELP YOU DID NOT ASK FOR

SKILL 11 · THE LAWN MUST GO ON · 1 AFTERNOON · EASY

Every autumn Grandfather rakes the leaves into one magnificent pile. Every autumn the zombies shuffle through it. This year, one of them picked up a rake. He is not good at it, but he is enthusiastic, and he will not go home.

1



Rake the First Pile

Long, steady strokes. Start at the fence and work toward the walk.

2



Notice Your Helper

If the leaves are moving the wrong way, someone else is raking.

3

Hand Him the Right End

Turn the rake over for him. Smile. He tried.



4



Rake Side by Side

You rake in, he rakes out. It evens out over the afternoon.

5



Bag the Leaves

Burlap sacks by the curb. Tie them tight.

6



Share the Cider

He will not drink it, but he will hold the cup. That is companionship.

NOTES

Turned neighbors love to help. Give them a job that cannot go wrong, like holding the bag open.

IMPORTANT

Never jump in the leaf pile in October. Something may be napping underneath.

MATERIALS

- A bamboo leaf rake



- Burlap sacks



- Work gloves



- A thermos of cider



- A second rake (for your helper)



HOW TO

WINNING YARD OF THE MONTH ANYWAY

SKILL 12 · THE LAWN MUST GO ON · 1 WEEK · HARD

The Garden Club announces Yard of the Month every first Saturday. The judges are three ladies with clipboards and very high standards. This month, two of the three judges have turned. Their standards are, if anything, higher, and they are much harder to impress.

MATERIALS


A lawn edger


A can of white paint


A paintbrush


Fresh flowers in pots


A pitcher of iced tea

1



Edge the Walk

A crisp edge says 'gentleman'. A ragged edge says 'bachelor'.

2



Inspect the Fence

Every picket white and upright. Touch up the paint, and let it dry before the shufflers lean on it.

3



Set Out Pots of Flowers

Red geraniums on each step. Judges love symmetry.

4



Welcome the Judges

Three ladies with clipboards. Two of them groan. Bow to all three.

5



Offer Iced Tea

The living judge will drink it. The others will admire the glass.



6 *Accept the Sign*

Plant it by the walk with pride. Yard of the Month.

NOTES

Turned judges award points for stillness. Keep the sprinkler off and the dog inside on judging day.

IMPORTANT

Never trim the judges' hedge for them. It looks like a bribe.

HOW TO

FIXING THE PICKET FENCE (AGAIN)

SKILL 13 · THE LAWN MUST GO ON · 1 AFTERNOON · MEDIUM

Zombies cannot open gates. They have tried. They lean on the fence instead, and the fence was built for leaning by people, not by six people at once. Every Saturday a gentleman repairs his picket fence. It is good exercise and it keeps the street looking tidy.

MATERIALS

- A claw hammer



- A box of nails



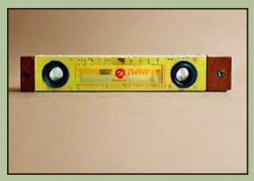
- Spare pickets



- A can of white paint



- A carpenter's level



1



Count the Broken Pickets

Walk the fence line slowly. Make a list.

2



Pull the Old Nails

Claw hammer, a firm rock, and out they come.

3

Nail In New Pickets

Two nails top, two nails bottom. Check with the level.



4



Paint Them White

New pickets stand out. Give them a coat to match.

5



Hang a Polite Sign

'Please Lean Gently.' They cannot read, but the mailman can.

6



Stand Back and Admire

A straight fence is a straight life.

NOTES

Build the fence one picket taller each year. By 1962 the zombies will lean on it with their elbows.

IMPORTANT

Do not electrify the fence, whatever Uncle Walt says. Mrs. Pettibone's curlers are metal.

CHAPTER THREE

3

KEEPING UP APPEARANCES

Dressing well, grooming well and looking respectable on a rumpled street







When half the street wears the same rumpled suit every day, it is tempting to let things slide. A gentleman does not let things slide. He shaves, he shines his shoes and he presses his trousers, because a well-dressed man is a beacon of civilization, and because Mrs. Pettibone across the street still notices a crooked tie. This chapter covers dress, grooming, the front porch and the delicate art of looking respectable while the neighbors groan.

IN THIS CHAPTER

14 Dressing Sharp When the Whole Block Is Rumpled
15 Shining Your Shoes for a World That Drags Its Feet
16 Hosting Bridge When One Guest Is Undead
17 The Front Porch Must Always Look Welcoming
18 Tipping Your Hat to a Neighbor Who Groans Back
19 Washing the Station Wagon With Spectators
20 Explaining the Neighbors to Visiting Relatives

HOW TO

DRESSING SHARP WHEN THE WHOLE BLOCK IS RUMPLED

SKILL 14 · KEEPING UP APPEARANCES · 15 MINUTES · EASY

The turned neighbors wear whatever they were wearing on the day they turned, every day, forever. Mr. Hale has been in the same brown suit since April. This is no excuse for the rest of us. A gentleman dresses as though the Garden Club were watching, because it is.

1



Lay Out Your Clothes

Suit, shirt and tie laid on the bed the night before.

2



Tie the Bow Tie

Left over right, fold, loop, tuck. Practice makes a gentleman.

3



Brush the Jacket

Every speck of lint off. Zombies shed, and so does the cat.

MATERIALS



A pressed gray suit



A clean white shirt



A red bow tie



A clothes brush



Polished shoes

4



Check the Mirror

Hat straight, tie straight, mustache trim.

5



Step Out Smartly

Down the walk with your chin up. The block is watching.

NOTES

Keep a spare bow tie in your desk drawer. Zombies grab at bright things and you will lose one now and then.

IMPORTANT

Never lend a turned neighbor your good jacket. You will never see it again, though you will see him in it daily.



6 *Nod to Mr. Hale*

His suit is rumpled, but he has kept his tie on. Credit where it is due.

HOW TO

SHINING YOUR SHOES FOR A WORLD THAT DRAGS ITS FEET

SKILL 15 · KEEPING UP APPEARANCES · 20 MINUTES · EASY

The undead drag their feet. Their shoes are scuffed, muddy and a disgrace. A gentleman's shoes, by contrast, shine like a Cadillac bumper. This sets a fine example, and some of the neighbors stand and stare at them for hours.

MATERIALS

- Black shoe polish



- A soft cloth



- A horsehair brush



- Old newspaper



- A pair of black shoes



1



Spread the Newspaper

On the back step. Polish is murder on linoleum.

2



Dab On the Polish

Small circles. Not too much.

3

Brush It to a Shine

Brisk strokes with the horsehair brush.



4



Buff With the Cloth

Snap the cloth. It is very satisfying.

5



Admire Your Reflection

If you can see your mustache in the toe, you are done.

6



Watch Them Watch

A turned neighbor will stand and stare at a good shine. Let him. It is a compliment.

NOTES

Polish your shoes every Sunday night. Zombies are drawn to shine, so you will always know where to find them.

IMPORTANT

Do not leave your polished shoes on the porch overnight. The milkman will put bottles in them.

HOW TO

HOSTING BRIDGE WHEN ONE GUEST IS UNDEAD

SKILL 16 · KEEPING UP APPEARANCES · 1 EVENING · MEDIUM

It is Mother's turn to host the couples' bridge night, and Mr. Hale is coming. He was invited in March, before he turned, and a lady never withdraws an invitation. With a little planning, the evening will be the talk of the block.

1



Set Two Tables

Four chairs at each. Put Mr. Hale at the table nearest the door.

2



Put Out the Coasters

Turned guests drool a little. Coasters save the furniture.

3



Greet Each Guest

Take coats at the door. His coat is mostly mud. Hang it on the porch.

MATERIALS


Two decks of cards


A bowl of mixed nuts


Coasters


A pitcher of punch


Folding chairs

4



Partner Him Wisely

Seat him with Grandfather, who is hard of hearing and will not notice the groaning.

5



Serve the Punch

A silver ladle and small cups. He will hold his for the whole evening.

NOTES

Turned guests always bid 'one club'. Plan your hand accordingly.

IMPORTANT

Do not serve shrimp cocktail. He thinks the shrimp are looking at him.



6 *Say Good Night at Ten*

Walk him to the door. Point him toward his own house. Give a little push.

HOW TO

THE FRONT PORCH MUST ALWAYS LOOK WELCOMING

SKILL 17 · KEEPING UP APPEARANCES · 1 AFTERNOON · EASY

MATERIALS

- A straw broom



- A welcome mat



- A pot of red geraniums



- A porch swing cushion



- A bottle of furniture polish



The front porch is the face of the household. It should say 'Welcome, friend.' Lately it has been saying 'Welcome, everyone,' because four turned neighbors fell asleep on the porch swing. A lady keeps her porch charming, swept and ready for callers of every kind.

1



Sweep the Boards

Front to back, every board. Zombies track in a great deal of yard.

2



Greet the Morning

Step out smartly, smooth your skirt, and give the street a cheerful wave.

3

Water the Geraniums

Red geraniums say 'respectable family'.



4



Plump the Swing Cushion

A cheerful cushion makes a porch. Turn it over if somebody drooled.

5



Wake the Sleepers Gently

A cheerful 'Yoo-hoo!' and they shuffle off. No brooms, please.

6



Switch On the Porch Light

A lit porch says 'decent people live here'.

NOTES

Put out a second, older swing at the far end of the porch. The zombies will choose it and leave the good one for callers.

IMPORTANT

Never put out a bowl of candy on the porch before Halloween. You will have company until Easter.

HOW TO

TIPPING YOUR HAT TO A NEIGHBOR WHO GROANS BACK

SKILL 18 · KEEPING UP APPEARANCES · 1 MINUTE · EASY

The tip of the hat is the gentleman's handshake. It costs nothing and it keeps a street civil. A turned neighbor cannot tip his hat back, but he will groan, and a groan, properly understood, is just a very slow 'Good day'.

1



Spot Your Neighbor
Ten paces away is the proper distance to begin.

2



Straighten Up
Shoulders back, chin level. A slouching hat-tip is worse than none.

3



Set the Brim
Hat level, an inch above the brows. A small nod. Not a wave. Never a wave.

MATERIALS


A gray fedora


A clean pair of gloves


Good posture


A friendly expression


A clear sidewalk

4



Say Good Day
'Good day, Mr. Hale.' Warm but brief.

5



Accept the Groan
'Uuurgh' means 'Good day to you, too, sir.' Nod again.

NOTES

Keep your hat on firmly in a crowd. Turned neighbors find fedoras fascinating and will try to try it on.

IMPORTANT

Never tip your hat to a zombie who is facing the other way. He will turn around, slowly, and you will be there all afternoon.



6 *Walk On Briskly*
Do not linger. A hat-tip is a greeting, not an invitation.

HOW TO

WASHING THE STATION WAGON WITH SPECTATORS

SKILL 19 · KEEPING UP APPEARANCES · 1 HOUR · EASY

MATERIALS

- A bucket of soapy water



- A big sponge



- A garden hose



- A chamois cloth



- A tin of car wax



Saturday afternoon Junior washes the station wagon. It earns him a quarter and it makes the driveway shine. It also draws a crowd, because zombies love bubbles more than anything in the world except brains and the sprinkler.

1



Fill the Bucket

Warm water and a good squirt of soap. Lots of bubbles.

2



Soap the Roof First

Top to bottom, or you will wash the same mud twice.

3

Notice the Audience

Three neighbors at the end of the driveway, staring at the bubbles.



4



Blow Them a Few Bubbles

It keeps them happy and out of the bucket.

5



Rinse Carefully

Hose the car, not the audience.

6



Dry and Wax

Chamois first, then wax. The neighbors will stare at the shine until dark.

NOTES

Save a bucket of bubbles for the end. Pour it out by the curb and the audience will follow it home.

IMPORTANT

Never let a zombie hold the hose. He will not let go, and he will not stop pointing it at you.

HOW TO

EXPLAINING THE NEIGHBORS TO VISITING RELATIVES

SKILL 20 · KEEPING UP APPEARANCES · 1 WEEKEND · HARD

Aunt Edna is coming from Toledo for the weekend. Aunt Edna has opinions about everything, and the neighborhood will give her a great deal to have opinions about. A wise lady prepares her, softens her and keeps her well supplied with coffee cake.

1



Make Up the Guest Room

Crisp sheets and fresh flowers. Close the curtains on the Hale side.

2



Meet Her at the Station

Hug first. Explain later.

3



Mention It Over Coffee Cake

'Edna, dear, some of the neighbors have changed a little.'

MATERIALS



A coffee cake



The guest room linens



A street map with notes



Aunt Edna's favorite tea



A pair of binoculars

4



Show Her the View

Let her look through the binoculars. Explain each house in turn.

5



Introduce Mrs. Pettibone

From the porch. Edna will say 'Well, I never.' She has now.

NOTES

Tell relatives the neighbors are 'from the old country'. It explains the groaning and nobody asks which country.

IMPORTANT

Do not let Aunt Edna offer to 'set them straight'. She tried with the Pettibones and lost a hat.



6 *Pack Her Some Coffee Cake*

She will tell everyone in Toledo. Send cake, so they say nice things.

CHAPTER FOUR

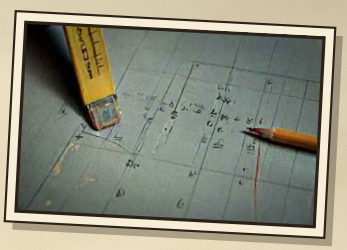
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POTLUCK AND SUPPER ETIQUETTE

Casseroles, seating charts and passing the gravy to the undead







Nothing brings a street together like a potluck supper, and nothing tests a hostess like a potluck supper where half the guests only want brains. Happily, the turned neighbors are not fussy. They will happily accept cauliflower, Jell-O and anything shaped like a brain, provided it is served with good manners. This chapter covers casseroles, seating, saying grace and the delicate business of getting everyone to go home afterward.

IN THIS CHAPTER

21 Bringing a Casserole to a Zombie Potluck
22 Serving Cauliflower and Calling It Brains
23 Seating Chart for the Living and the Less So
24 Saying Grace Over the Groaning
25 Passing the Gravy to a Zombie
26 The Jell-O Mold That Wobbled Back
27 Clearing the Table When the Guests Will Not Leave

HOW TO

BRINGING A CASSEROLE TO A ZOMBIE POTLUCK

SKILL 21 · POTLUCK AND SUPPER ETIQUETTE · 1 AFTERNOON · EASY

The church hall potluck is on Friday and the sign-up sheet says 'Everyone welcome (yes, everyone)'. A lady brings a casserole. The question is which one, because half the guests will eat anything and the other half will only eat what looks like a brain.

1



Choose a Sturdy Dish

Something heavy that will not tip if a guest bumps the table. They bump the table.

2



Make the Tuna Noodle

Noodles, soup, tuna, peas and crushed potato chips on top. A classic.

3

Bake Until Golden

Thirty minutes at three hundred and fifty. The smell will bring the Hales to the window.



4



Label Your Dish

A strip of tape with your name. You will want that dish back.

5



Carry It in a Tea Towel

Hot dishes need a towel. Walk steadily past the shufflers on the church steps.

6



Set It on the Long Table

Between the deviled eggs and the Jell-O. Prime position.

NOTES

Put a sprig of parsley on top. The turned guests think it is a tiny tree and leave the rest alone.

IMPORTANT

Never bring the spaghetti. Zombies cannot manage spaghetti, and you will be finding noodles in the hymnals until Easter.

MATERIALS

- A casserole dish



- Egg noodles



- A can of mushroom soup



- A tea towel



- A masking-tape name label



HOW TO

SERVING CAULIFLOWER AND CALLING IT BRAINS

SKILL 22 · POTLUCK AND SUPPER ETIQUETTE · 30 MINUTES · MEDIUM

The undead want brains. Brains are hard to come by in a decent neighborhood. Cauliflower, however, is twelve cents a head at the Piggly Wiggly, and with a little cheese sauce and a confident voice, nobody need ever know the difference.

MATERIALS


Two heads of cauliflower

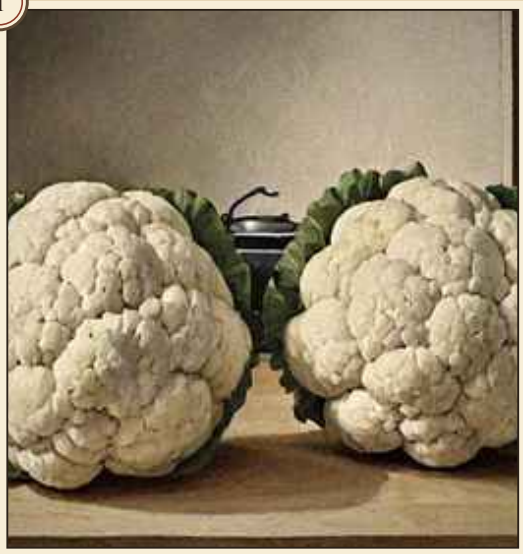

A block of cheddar cheese


A saucepan


A silver serving platter


A sprig of parsley

1



Choose Big Heads

The bigger and lumpier, the more convincing.

2



Steam Them Whole

Twelve minutes in a covered pot. Keep them in one piece.

3



Make the Cheese Sauce

Butter, flour, milk and cheddar. Stir constantly.

4



Pour It On Thickly

A pinkish sauce is more convincing. A drop of beet juice does it.

5



Announce It Grandly

Carry it in and say 'Brains, anyone?' The table will moan with joy.



6 ### *Watch Them Enjoy It*

They will never know. Neither should Aunt Edna.

NOTES

Serve it on your best silver. Presentation is everything, and the undead are very impressed by a shiny platter.

IMPORTANT

Do not tell Mr. Hale it is cauliflower, even after the third helping. He gets very sad.

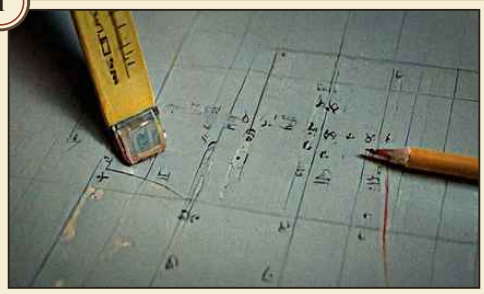
HOW TO

SEATING CHART FOR THE LIVING AND THE LESS SO

SKILL 23 · POTLUCK AND SUPPER ETIQUETTE · 1 HOUR · HARD

A good seating chart is the secret of a good dinner party. It keeps the talkers apart, the shy ones together and, these days, the turned guests at a sensible distance from anyone wearing a bouffant.

1



Draw the Table

A neat rectangle on graph paper. Mark the doors.

2



Living at the Ends

Put the hosts at the head and foot, so they can see everything.

3

Alternate Thoughtfully

Living, turned, living, turned. It keeps the conversation lively. Or at least moving.



4



Write the Place Cards

In your best handwriting. They cannot read them, but the gesture counts.

5



Keep Mr. Hale From the Centerpiece

He likes to eat the flowers. Put him at the far end.

6



Admire Your Work

A well-planned table is a peaceful table.

NOTES

Seat the deaf uncles next to the groaners. Everyone has a lovely time.

IMPORTANT

Never seat two turned guests side by side. They will lean on each other and fall asleep before the soup.

MATERIALS

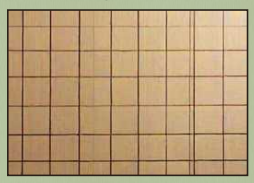
- Place cards



- A fountain pen



- A sheet of graph paper



- A ruler



- A centerpiece of flowers



HOW TO

SAYING GRACE OVER THE GROANING

SKILL 24 · POTLUCK AND SUPPER ETIQUETTE · 2 MINUTES · MEDIUM

Grandfather has said grace at the family table for forty years. He has never been interrupted. Now the Hales come to Sunday supper, and Mr. Hale groans at every pause. Grandfather has learned to work with it.

MATERIALS


A family Bible

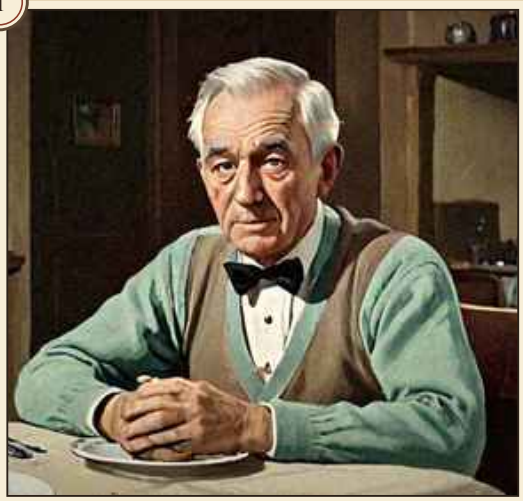

A white tablecloth


A Sunday roast


Your reading glasses

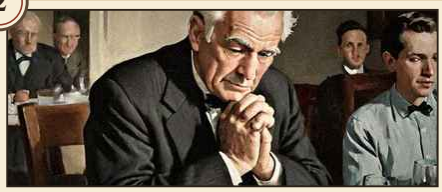

A patient heart

1 *Wait for Quiet*



Clear your throat and fold your hands. Wait for the forks to go down.

2 *Bow Your Head*



Everyone bows. Mr. Hale's head was already hanging. That counts.

3 *Speak Up Clearly*



A strong voice carries over the groaning.

4 *Pause for the Groan*

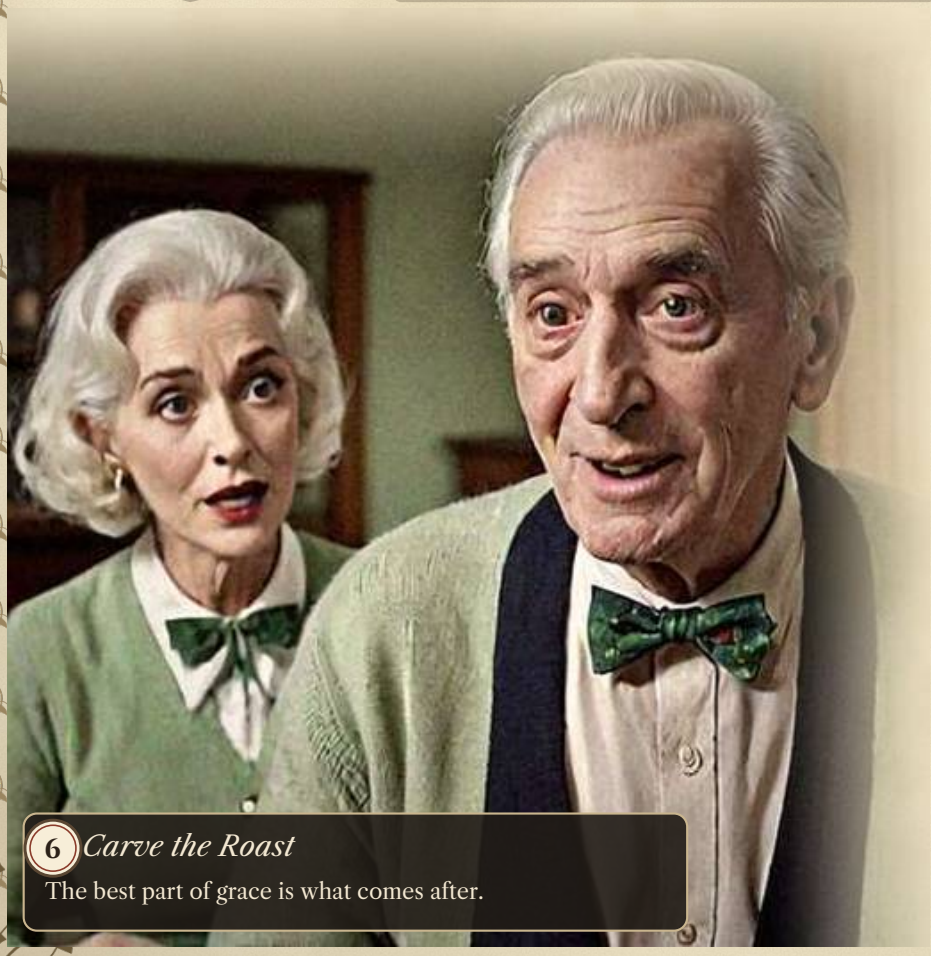


Leave a small gap after each line. It sounds a little like 'Amen'.

5 *Finish Strong*



'And bless the neighbors, every one.' Then a firm 'Amen'.



6 *Carve the Roast*

The best part of grace is what comes after.

NOTES

Keep grace under one minute when the turned are at table. They lose interest and wander toward the kitchen.

IMPORTANT

Never ask Mr. Hale to say grace. He will try, and supper will be cold by the end of it.

HOW TO

PASSING THE GRAVY TO A ZOMBIE

SKILL 25 · POTLUCK AND SUPPER ETIQUETTE · 1 MINUTE · HARD

Passing the gravy is a gentleman's sacred duty. To the left, handle first, with a small nod. Passing it to a zombie neighbor is a sterner test. He will reach for it slowly, miss, and reach again, and the gravy is hot.

1



Fill the Boat Halfway

Never full. You are passing to a man with no aim.

2



Set It on a Saucer

A saucer catches drips and gives him a bigger target.

3

Turn the Handle Toward Him

Handle first, always.



4



Hold It Until He Has It

Do not let go until both his hands are on the saucer. Be patient.

5



Mop Up Calmly

If it spills, a linen napkin and a smile. Never a fuss.

6



Pour It for Him

Next time, simply pour it on his potatoes yourself. That is true courtesy.

NOTES

Put a dish of gravy at each end of the table. Then nobody has to pass anything to anybody.

IMPORTANT

Never pass the gravy behind his back. He will turn to follow it and sit on the cat.

MATERIALS

- A china gravy boat



- A saucer



- A linen napkin



- A steady hand



- Mashed potatoes



HOW TO

THE JELL-O MOLD THAT WOBBLED BACK

SKILL 26 · POTLUCK AND SUPPER ETIQUETTE · 1 AFTERNOON · MEDIUM

Sally made her first Jell-O mold for the block potluck: lime, with grapes and little marshmallows suspended inside. It wobbles beautifully. The turned neighbors adore it. They think it is alive, and they stand around it for hours wobbling back.

MATERIALS


A packet of lime Jell-O


A ring mold


Green grapes


Mini marshmallows


A cake plate

1



Stir the Jell-O

Boiling water, then cold. Stir until it is clear.

2



Add the Grapes

Drop them in one at a time. Count them. Forty is lucky.

3



Chill Overnight

In the refrigerator, on the top shelf, away from Father's pickles.

4



Turn It Out

Dip in warm water, flip onto the plate, say a little prayer.

5



Watch It Wobble

A gentle tap and it shimmies. The whole table will stare.



6 *Let Them Admire It*

The turned neighbors will sway along with it. It is rather sweet.

NOTES

Lime is the favorite. The turned neighbors find it very relatable.

IMPORTANT

Never put the Jell-O near the window. It attracts a crowd from the street.

HOW TO

CLEARING THE TABLE WHEN THE GUESTS WILL NOT LEAVE

SKILL 27 · POTLUCK AND SUPPER ETIQUETTE · 1 HOUR · HARD

Supper is over. The dishes are done. The coffee is cold. The living guests went home at nine. The turned guests are still at the table, staring at the salt shaker, and it is nearly midnight. A gentleman must end the evening without being rude.

1



Clear the Plates

Briskly, with a tray. Visible tidying is a strong hint.

2



Yawn Politely

A large yawn behind the hand. Then another.

3

Put On Your Hat and Coat

Say 'Well! Look at the time.' Stand by the door.



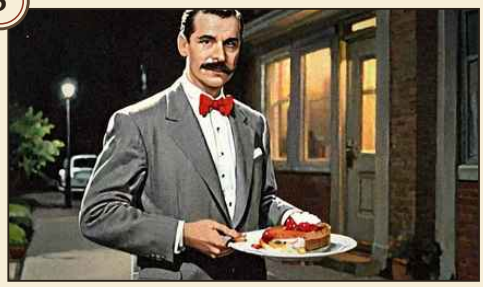
4



Switch Off the Lights

One by one. They follow the last light.

5



Lead Them With Pie

Carry the pie plate out the door and down the walk. They will follow.

6



Leave the Pie on Their Porch

Set it down, tip your hat and walk home quickly.

NOTES

Start clearing the table at half past eight. Zombies take two hours to notice anything.

IMPORTANT

Never say 'Stay as long as you like.' They will. They do not need sleep.

MATERIALS

- A tray



- A dish towel



- Your hat and coat



- A flashlight



- A plate of leftover pie



CHAPTER FIVE

5

NEIGHBORLY MANNERS

Borrowing, lending, small talk and gossip over the back fence







A good neighbor lends a cup of sugar, returns the lawn mower and never gossips about the Hendersons, at least not before lunch. These rules hold whether the neighbor is breathing or not. The turned folks on the block are still neighbors, after all. They still borrow things, they still bake fruitcakes and they still stand at the fence every evening expecting a chat. This chapter is about keeping the peace across the picket line.

IN THIS CHAPTER

28 Lending a Cup of Sugar Over the Fence
29 Accepting a Fruitcake From the Undead
30 Making Small Talk With a Groaner
31 Returning a Borrowed Lawn Mower
32 Gossip Over the Clothesline
33 Writing a Thank-You Note They Cannot Read

HOW TO

LENDING A CUP OF SUGAR OVER THE FENCE

SKILL 28 · NEIGHBORLY MANNERS · 5 MINUTES · EASY

Mrs. Pettibone has been asking for a cup of sugar every morning since she turned. She does not bake anymore. She simply holds out the cup and groans. A good neighbor fills it anyway. What she does with all that sugar is her own business.

1



Hear the Groan

Seven o'clock sharp, at the fence. You will know it.

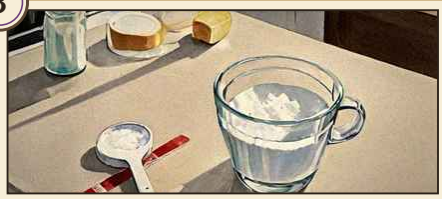
2



Fetch the Canister

The big tin with the roses on it.

3



Measure It Level

A level cup. A heaped cup sets a dangerous example.

MATERIALS


A cup of sugar


A measuring cup


A sugar canister


A dish towel


A friendly word

4



Pour It Into Her Cup

Over the fence, slowly. Do not spill on the pickets.

5



Say Something Nice

'Lovely curlers today, Edith.' She will groan with pleasure.

NOTES

Keep a separate canister for Mrs. Pettibone and fill it every Sunday. It saves a trip to the pantry.

IMPORTANT

Never lend her the brown sugar. She thinks it is something else and gets terribly excited.



6 *Keep a Tally*

Pencil marks on the pantry door. She owes you thirty-one cups.

HOW TO

ACCEPTING A FRUITCAKE FROM THE UNDEAD

SKILL 29 · NEIGHBORLY MANNERS · 10 MINUTES · MEDIUM

Mrs. Pettibone has baked a fruitcake. Nobody knows how. It is wrapped in foil and tied with ribbon, and she is holding it out on the doorstep with a hopeful groan. A lady accepts every gift graciously, especially this one.

MATERIALS

- A cake tin



- A sharp knife



- A doily



- A thank-you card



- A cup of strong tea



1



Open the Door With a Smile
Whatever she is holding, smile first.

2



Accept It With Both Hands
It is heavy. Fruitcake always is. This one more so.

3

Say Thank You Warmly
'Edith, you shouldn't have.' Mean it as much as you can.



4



Unwrap It in the Kitchen
Privately. Brace yourself.

5



Cut a Thin Slice
Very thin. A sharp knife and a firm wrist.

6



Store It Forever
Fruitcake keeps for eleven years. Put it in the tin and wait for Christmas.

NOTES

Always say the fruitcake was 'very moist'. It is the safest compliment in the English language.

IMPORTANT

Do not ask what is in it. She will try to tell you, and it takes most of an afternoon.

HOW TO

MAKING SMALL TALK WITH A GROANER

SKILL 30 · NEIGHBORLY MANNERS · 15 MINUTES · MEDIUM

Every evening at six Mr. Hale stands at the fence and waits. He wants a chat. He cannot say anything except 'Uuurgh', but he listens beautifully, and a gentleman never turns down a chat with a neighbor.

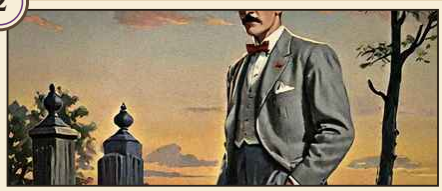
1



Stroll to the Fence

Hands in pockets, unhurried. Lean on the post, not the pickets.

2



Open With the Weather

'Fine evening, Hale.' The weather is always safe.

3



Mention the Ball Game

He was a Dodgers man. He groans louder for the Dodgers.

MATERIALS



A pipe (unlit)



The evening paper



A few safe topics



A porch chair



Good weather

4



Listen Patiently

Nod at each groan. He is telling you something. Possibly about the Dodgers.

5



Avoid Politics

He is undead. You do not want to know how he votes.

NOTES

Groaners are the best listeners on the block. Tell Mr. Hale your troubles. He will never repeat a word.

IMPORTANT

Never ask a turned neighbor 'How are you?' The answer is obvious and it embarrasses him.



6 *Say Good Night*

'Well, Hale, the wife will want me.' Pat the fence and go in.

HOW TO

RETURNING A BORROWED LAWN MOWER

SKILL 31 · NEIGHBORLY MANNERS · 15 MINUTES · EASY

You borrowed Mr. Hale's mower in the spring, before he turned. A gentleman returns what he borrows, cleaned, oiled and sharpened. The fact that Mr. Hale no longer mows is beside the point. It is his mower.

MATERIALS

- The borrowed mower



- An oil can



- A sharpening file



- A rag



- A thank-you note



1



Clean the Blades

Grass off, rust off. Make it better than you found it.

2



Oil the Wheels

Three drops on each wheel. Spin to check.

3

Sharpen the Reel

A neighbor's mower should cut better when it comes home.



4



Push It Across

Through the gate, up his walk, to the garage door.

5



Hand Him the Note

'Thank you for the loan, Hale. She runs like a dream.'

6



Put It Away Yourself

He will not. Park it neatly in his garage and close the door.

NOTES

Borrow from the turned neighbors sparingly. They lend anything, but they never ask for it back, and that is a temptation.

IMPORTANT

Never return a borrowed tool to a zombie's hands. He will hold it until Tuesday. Set it down.

HOW TO

GOSSIP OVER THE CLOTHESLINE

SKILL 32 · NEIGHBORLY MANNERS · 20 MINUTES · MEDIUM

Monday is wash day, and wash day is gossip day. The ladies of the street hang out the sheets and trade news over the line. These days the news is mostly about who has turned, and the trick is to share it without being unkind.

1



Hang the Sheets

Shake them out, pin the corners. Snap them straight.

2



Peek Over the Line

That is where the news is.

3



Share Gently

'I hear the Hendersons have turned.' Not 'gone green'. Never 'gone green'.

MATERIALS



A basket of laundry



Wooden clothespins



A clothesline



A bag of news



Kind words

4



Notice Who Is Listening

If the sheet next door is groaning, change the subject.

5



Say Something Kind

'She still keeps a lovely garden.' Always end on something kind.

NOTES

Hang the colored wash on the outside line. Zombies get tangled in sheets, but they leave the dungarees alone.

IMPORTANT

Never gossip about a turned neighbor's complexion. She is very sensitive about it.



6 *Take the Wash In*

Before the evening shuffle. They like to walk through the sheets.

HOW TO

WRITING A THANK-YOU NOTE THEY CANNOT READ

SKILL 33 · NEIGHBORLY MANNERS · 15 MINUTES · EASY

Mrs. Pettibone gave Sally a hair ribbon for her birthday. It is a little chewed, but it is the thought that counts. A well-brought-up girl writes a thank-you note within the week, even when the recipient cannot read a word of it.

MATERIALS

- Nice notepaper



- A fountain pen



- An envelope



- A three-cent stamp



- Your best handwriting



1



Sit at the Desk

Back straight, paper square, pen uncapped.

2



Write 'Dear Mrs. Pettibone'

Neatly. The first line sets the tone.

3

Mention the Gift

'Thank you for the lovely ribbon.' Do not mention the chewing.



4



Add a Drawing

She cannot read, but she likes pictures. A flower will do.

5



Seal and Stamp It

Lick the stamp, press it in the corner.

6



Deliver It by Hand

Slip it in her mailbox. She will groan at it fondly for weeks.

NOTES

Read the note aloud on her porch as well. She will not understand it, but she will enjoy the attention.

IMPORTANT

Never use scented notepaper. She will try to eat it.

CHAPTER SIX

6

THE FAMILY AND THE UNDEAD

Children, pets, grandparents and babysitters on a turned street







Children adapt to anything. Within a week of the first neighbor turning, Junior was selling them lemonade and Sally had taught the Hales' poodle to sit. It is the grown-ups who need help. This chapter covers manners for the children, the care of turned pets, Grandmother's knitting circle and the question every mother asks: is it all right to leave the children with a sitter who groans?

IN THIS CHAPTER

34 Teaching the Children to Say 'Good Morning, Mr. Hale'

35 When the Dog Brings Home a Zombie Poodle

36 Running a Lemonade Stand on a Slow-Moving Street

37 Grandmother's Knitting Circle Gets a New Member

38 Hide and Seek Rules for the Whole Block

39 Interviewing a Babysitter Who Shuffles

HOW TO

TEACHING THE CHILDREN TO SAY 'GOOD MORNING, MR. HALE'

SKILL 34 · THE FAMILY AND THE UNDEAD · 1 WEEK · EASY

Children should greet every neighbor by name, with a smile, every morning. This rule does not change because Mr. Hale has turned. If anything, he appreciates it more, because nobody else says good morning to him anymore.

MATERIALS


A good example


Clean faces


Combed hair


Lunch boxes


A gold star chart

1



Line Them Up

Faces washed, hair combed, at the front door by half past seven.

2



Show Them How

Mother goes first. 'Good morning, Mr. Hale!' Bright and clear.

3



Junior's Turn

Loud enough to hear, not loud enough to wake the Pettibones.

4



Sally's Turn

With a little curtsy. Mr. Hale loves the curtsy.

5



Wait for the Groan

That means 'Good morning, children.' Smile back.



6 ### *Award Gold Stars*

One star each on the kitchen chart. Five stars earn a malted.

NOTES

Children who greet the turned neighbors every day are never chased by them. They are simply followed around, fondly.

IMPORTANT

Never let the children call him 'Mr. Zombie'. His name is Mr. Hale, and he was an elder at First Methodist.

HOW TO

WHEN THE DOG BRINGS HOME A ZOMBIE POODLE

SKILL 35 · THE FAMILY AND THE UNDEAD · 1 AFTERNOON · MEDIUM

Rusty, our spaniel, came home from the park with a friend: the Hales' poodle, Fifi, who turned along with the rest of the household. She is green, she is droopy, and she will not leave Rusty's side. Junior is in charge of the situation.

1



Meet the New Friend

Kneel down, hold out the back of your hand. Let her sniff.

2



Set Out a Second Bowl

She will not eat, but she likes to have a bowl like Rusty.

3

Brush Her Fur

Gently. Bits come off. That is all right.



4



Teach Her to Sit

She already does. She sits everywhere. That is half the battle.

5



Take Them Both for a Walk

Two leashes, slowly. Fifi sets the pace.

6



Walk Her Home at Supper

Back to the Hales' porch. She will be back tomorrow.

NOTES

Turned pets are very loyal. Fifi will guard your porch better than any watchdog. Mostly she will sleep on it.

IMPORTANT

Do not throw a stick for Fifi. She will fetch it, eventually. Next Thursday.

MATERIALS

- Two dog bowls



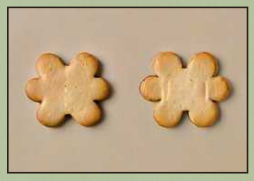
- A leash



- A dog brush



- A box of dog biscuits



- An old blanket



HOW TO

RUNNING A LEMONADE STAND ON A SLOW-MOVING STREET

SKILL 36 · THE FAMILY AND THE UNDEAD · 1 AFTERNOON · EASY

Every summer Sally runs a lemonade stand at the end of the walk. Business has never been better. The turned neighbors cannot resist it. They have no money and they do not drink lemonade, but they line up anyway, and the line goes around the block.

MATERIALS


A card table


A pitcher of lemonade


Paper cups


A cigar box for money


A painted sign

1



Set Up the Stand

A card table at the end of the walk, in the shade of the elm.

2



Make the Lemonade

Lemons, sugar, water and lots of ice. Stir with a wooden spoon.

3



Paint a Sign

Big letters. Five cents a cup.

4



Greet Your Customers

Every customer gets a smile. Even the ones that groan.

5



Serve the Line

One cup each. They will hold it and stand there. That is fine.



6 *Count the Money*

Three nickels, a button and a bottle cap. A fine day's trade.

NOTES

Charge the turned customers in hugs instead of nickels. You will run out of lemonade before they run out of hugs.

IMPORTANT

Never set up the stand on the Hales' side of the street. They will never leave.

HOW TO

GRANDMOTHER'S KNITTING CIRCLE GETS A NEW MEMBER

SKILL 37 · THE FAMILY AND THE UNDEAD · 1 AFTERNOON · MEDIUM

The Thursday knitting circle has met in Grandmother's parlor since 1931. This week Mrs. Pettibone came, as she always has. She has turned, but she has not lost her love of yarn. She cannot knit anymore. She can, however, hold a ball of wool very still.

1



Set Out the Chairs
In a circle, with a footstool for each.

2



Pour the Tea
Milk first. Grandmother is particular.

3

Give Her the Yarn
One ball of pink wool. She will hold it happily all afternoon.



4



Knit Your Own Rows
Knit two, purl two, and keep talking.

5



Untangle Her Gently
By four o'clock she will be wrapped in it. Unwind patiently.

6



Knit Her a Scarf
Green, to match. She will wear it every day.

NOTES

Give turned members the biggest needles. They cannot knit with them, but they look so proud.

IMPORTANT

Never leave a turned member alone with the shortbread. The tin will be empty and so will her expression.

MATERIALS

- Knitting needles



- Balls of yarn



- A knitting pattern



- A pot of tea



- A tin of shortbread



HOW TO

HIDE AND SEEK RULES FOR THE WHOLE BLOCK

SKILL 38 · THE FAMILY AND THE UNDEAD · 1 AFTERNOON · EASY

The children on the block have played hide and seek every summer evening since the war. The turned neighbors now want to play. They are terrible at hiding and even worse at seeking, so the children have written new rules.

MATERIALS


A big oak tree to count against


A wristwatch


A whistle


A list of rules


Good hiding spots

1



Agree on the Rules

No hiding in the root cellar. No hiding in the Hales' house.

2



Count Against the Oak

Eyes covered, count to a hundred. Slowly.

3



Hide Somewhere Sensible

Behind the hedge, in the garage, under the porch. Not up the chimney.

4



Find the Zombie First

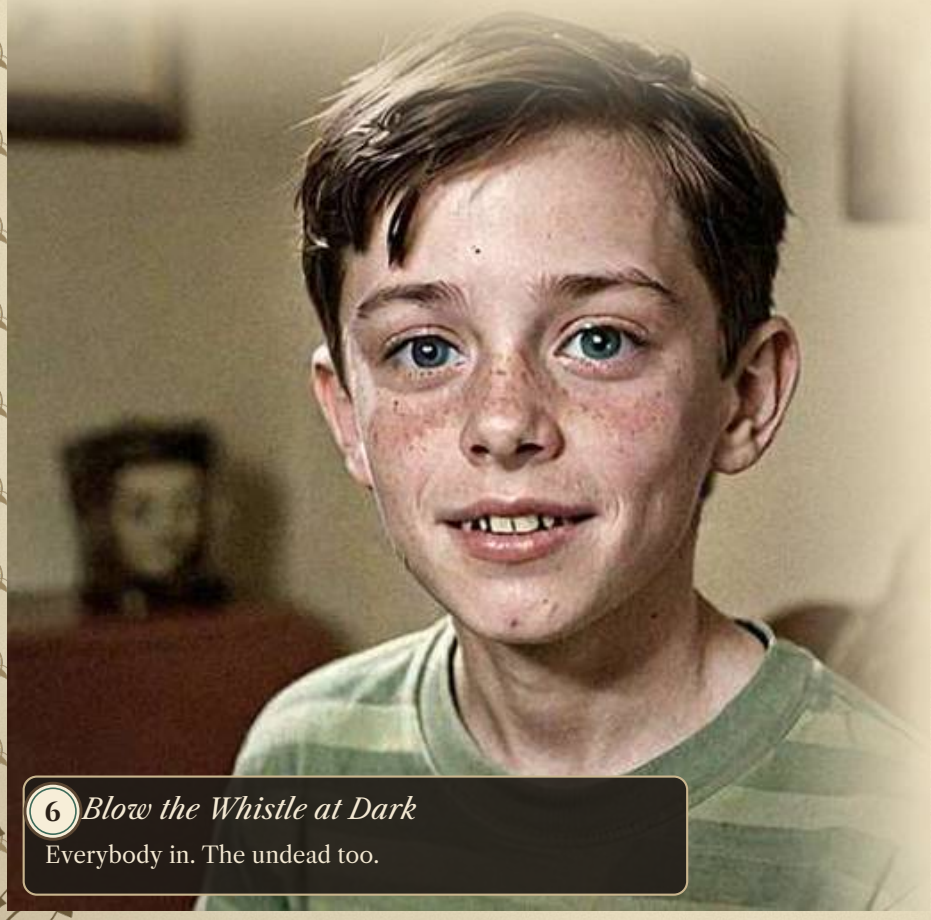
He is always behind the same tree with his feet showing.

5



Give Them a Turn to Seek

They count to three and then forget. Go and help them.



6 ### *Blow the Whistle at Dark*

Everybody in. The undead too.

NOTES

Let the turned neighbors hide first. You will find them in seconds and everyone feels clever.

IMPORTANT

Never play hide and seek in the cemetery. It is confusing for everybody.

HOW TO

INTERVIEWING A BABYSITTER WHO SHUFFLES

SKILL 39 · THE FAMILY AND THE UNDEAD · 1 HOUR · HARD

Mother and Father have tickets to the Rotary dance. The only sitter free on Saturday is Miss Gertie Plum from Elm Street, who is lovely with children and turned last June. A careful mother interviews her properly before leaving her with the children.

1



Invite Her for Tea

Sit her in the good chair and offer a cookie.

2



Ask About Experience

She has raised four of her own. She groans this proudly.

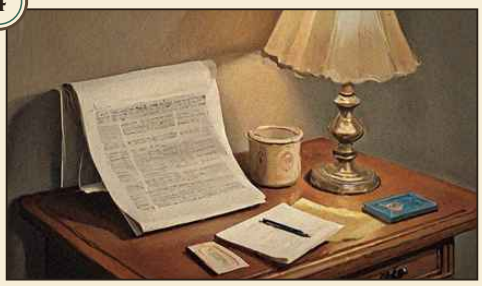
3

Watch Her With the Children

Sally reads to her. She listens beautifully.



4



Explain the Bedtimes

Junior at eight, Sally at half past seven. Write it on the card.

5



Leave the Phone Numbers

The Rotary hall, the doctor and Grandmother.

6



Come Home Early

The children will be asleep. So will she, on her feet.

NOTES

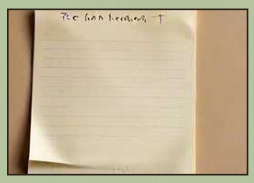
Turned sitters never let the children stay up late. They cannot stay up at all. They simply stand in the corner until morning.

IMPORTANT

Never leave the sitter in charge of the dog. They will both be on the porch staring at the moon when you get home.

MATERIALS

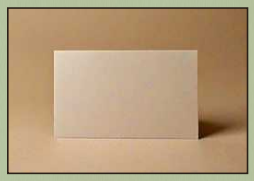
- A list of questions



- The children's bedtimes



- Emergency phone numbers



- A plate of cookies



- The house rules



CHAPTER SEVEN

7

OUT AND ABOUT TOWN

Church, the barber, the grocery, the bowling alley and the office







It is not only our street. Main Street has turned too, about half of it. The barber, the mailman, two of the deacons and most of the Tuesday bowling league now shuffle where they used to stroll. A gentleman still goes to town. He still gets his hair cut on Saturday, still bowls on Tuesday and still sits in the third pew. He simply allows a little more time, and keeps his hat on firmly.

IN THIS CHAPTER

40 Church on Sunday, Groans in the Pew
41 Getting a Haircut From a Zombie Barber
42 Grocery Shopping When the Aisles Are Slow
43 Bowling Night With a Team That Will Not Hurry
44 A Round of Golf With the Undead Foursome
45 Riding the Office Elevator With the Undead
46 Collecting the Mail From a Zombie Mailman

HOW TO

CHURCH ON SUNDAY, GROANS IN THE PEW

SKILL 40 · OUT AND ABOUT TOWN · 1 MORNING · MEDIUM

First Methodist has never missed a Sunday service, and it is not about to start now. About a third of the congregation has turned. They still come. They still sit in their usual pews. They groan during the sermon, which, the Reverend says, is no worse than the snoring.

1



Arrive Early

Get your usual pew before the shufflers drift into it.

2



Sit Up Straight

Gloves on, hymnal open on your lap.

3



Sing Out

Loud and true. It drowns out the groaning nicely.

MATERIALS



Your Sunday hat



White gloves



A hymnal



A dime for the plate



A handkerchief

4



Mind the Pew in Front

Mr. Hale nods off forward. Do not let him land in Mrs. Abernathy's hat.

5



Pass the Collection Plate

A dime in, then pass. If a turned neighbor holds onto it, tap his elbow.

NOTES

Sit near the aisle. When the turned folks get up to wander during the sermon, you can let them out without a fuss.

IMPORTANT

Never sing 'Onward Christian Soldiers' too loudly. The turned congregation will march out of the church and down Main Street.



6 ### *Shake the Reverend's Hand*

At the door, on the way out. Compliment the sermon.

HOW TO

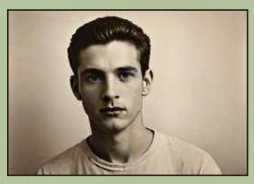
GETTING A HAIRCUT FROM A ZOMBIE BARBER

SKILL 41 · OUT AND ABOUT TOWN · 30 MINUTES · HARD

Gus has cut hair on Main Street for thirty years. He turned in the spring. His hands are not quite as steady, and he no longer talks about the ball game, but a gentleman stays loyal to his barber. With a few precautions, you will leave looking almost exactly like yourself.

MATERIALS

- A photograph of your usual haircut



- A quarter for the tip



- Your hat (for afterward)



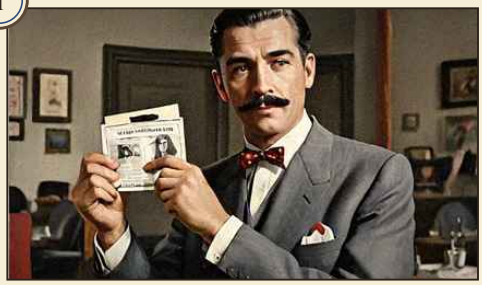
- A magazine



- Courage



1



Bring a Photograph

Show him what you want. Point to it. Slowly.

2



Sit Very Still

Not a twitch. He works best on a still target.

3

Watch in the Mirror

If he picks up the clippers upside down, speak up.



4



Accept the Result

A little crooked is still a haircut.

5



Tip Him Anyway

A quarter on the counter. He has a family, sort of.

6



Put Your Hat On

A fedora hides most sins. Tip it at the door.

NOTES

Ask for 'just a trim'. The less he does, the better it goes.

IMPORTANT

Never accept the shave. Not the shave. Never the shave.

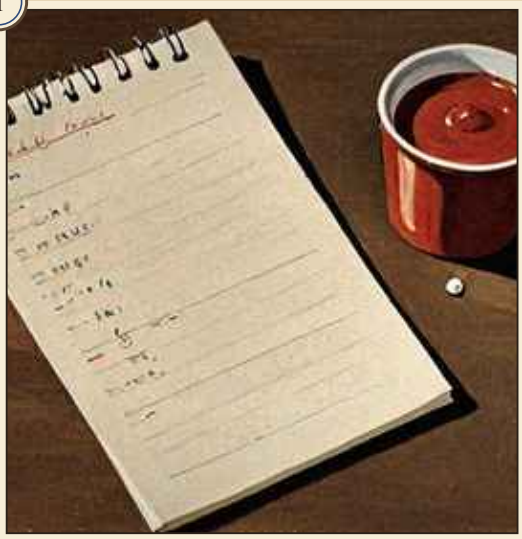
HOW TO

GROCERY SHOPPING WHEN THE AISLES ARE SLOW

SKILL 42 · OUT AND ABOUT TOWN · 1 HOUR · MEDIUM

The Piggly Wiggly is still open, but the aisles are full of turned shoppers who have been pushing the same cart since Wednesday. They are not in a hurry. A lady with a list and a schedule must learn to get around them, politely.

1



Write a Tidy List

Arrange it by aisle. You will not want to go back.

2



Take a Cart

Choose one with four good wheels. The squeaky ones attract followers.

3



Steer Around the Browsers

If someone is staring at the soup cans, go around. They may be there all day.

MATERIALS



Your grocery list



A string shopping bag



Exact change



A pencil



Patience

4



Pick Out the Produce

Firm tomatoes, crisp lettuce. Cauliflower, of course.

5



Mind the Checkout

The cashier is alive. Thank her warmly. She has had a long week.

NOTES

Shop on Thursday morning. The turned shoppers sleep standing up in the frozen foods until noon.

IMPORTANT

Never leave your cart unattended. A turned shopper will take it over and push it gently for weeks.



6 *Carry It Home*

String bag in each hand, chin up, past the slow ones on the sidewalk.

HOW TO

BOWLING NIGHT WITH A TEAM THAT WILL NOT HURRY

SKILL 43 · OUT AND ABOUT TOWN · 1 EVENING · EASY

Tuesday night is league night at the Starlite Lanes. Our team, the Elm Street Pinheads, has three turned members out of five. They bowl very slowly, but they bowl surprisingly straight, and we are in second place.

MATERIALS

- Your bowling ball



- Bowling shoes



- A score sheet



- A pencil



- A team shirt



1



Put On the Team Shirt

Matching shirts make a team.

2



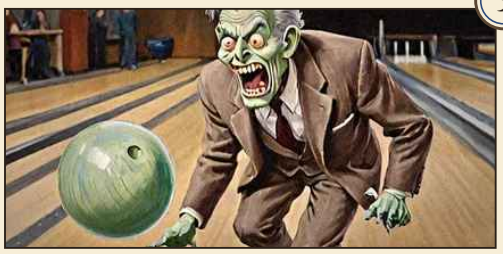
Lace Up the Shoes

Rented shoes, double knot.

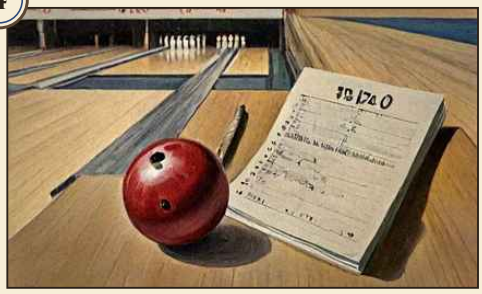
3

Let Them Bowl First

Each roll takes about a minute. Use the time to keep score.



4



Keep the Score

In pencil. They are surprisingly good at spares.

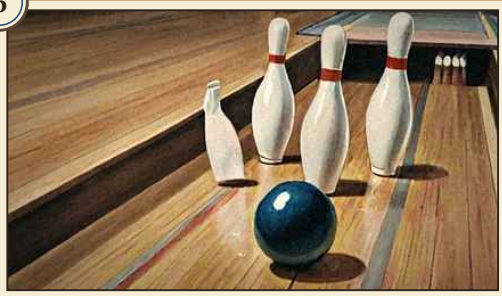
5



Take Your Turn

Four steps, smooth release. Do not show off.

6



Celebrate the Strike

A hearty 'Attaboy!' and a pat on the back. Gently. Things come loose.

NOTES

Turned bowlers never get nervous. Put them in the tenth frame.

IMPORTANT

Never let a turned teammate put his fingers in the ball's holes. You will not get the ball back.

HOW TO

A ROUND OF GOLF WITH THE UNDEAD FOURSOME

SKILL 44 · OUT AND ABOUT TOWN · 1 AFTERNOON · MEDIUM

Saturday golf with the fellows from the office has been a tradition for nine years. This year two of the foursome have turned. They still turn up at the first tee at eight sharp. They no longer hit the ball, but they walk the course with great dignity.

1



Meet at the First Tee

Eight o'clock, as always. Shake hands with the living.

2



Tee Off First

A good drive sets the tone.

3



Wait for the Foursome

They will walk toward the ball very slowly. Enjoy the scenery.

MATERIALS


A bag of golf clubs


Golf balls


Wooden tees


A scorecard


A golf cap

4



Retrieve Them From the Bunker

They like the sand trap. Lead them out by the elbow.

5



Putt Out

Steady hands, firm stroke.

NOTES

Turned golfers never cheat on the scorecard. They also never finish a hole. It evens out.

IMPORTANT

Never yell 'Fore!' near the undead foursome. They will all turn around to look and walk into the pond.



6 *Mark the Scorecard Kindly*

Give everyone a five. It is a friendly game.

HOW TO

RIDING THE OFFICE ELEVATOR WITH THE UNDEAD

SKILL 45 · OUT AND ABOUT TOWN · 5 MINUTES · MEDIUM

The Consolidated Insurance building has eleven floors and one elevator. Half the accounting department has turned. They ride the elevator all day, up and down, because they cannot remember which floor they work on.

MATERIALS

- Your briefcase



- Your hat



- A cheerful 'Good morning'



- Your floor number



- A little patience

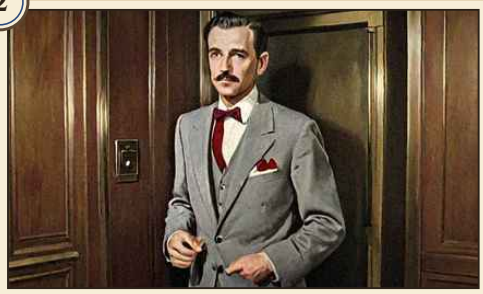


1



Press the Button
Once. Pressing it twice does not help.

2



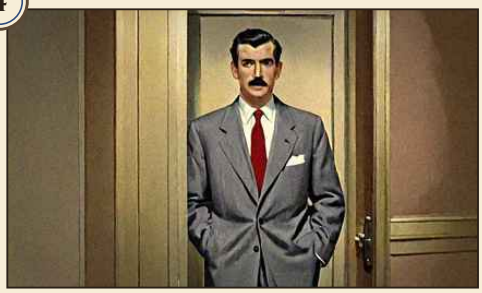
Step In Smartly
Hat off in the elevator. Always.

3

Greet Everyone
'Morning, fellows.' A soft groan in reply is normal.



4



Face the Front
Eyes on the floor numbers. Elevator etiquette is the same for everyone.

5



Press Their Floor for Them
Accounting is the seventh. Press seven and they will get off, eventually.

6



Step Out at Your Floor
Say 'Have a good day.' They will be riding until five.

NOTES

Take the stairs on Monday morning. The elevator is very crowded and none of them are getting off.

IMPORTANT

Never push the emergency stop. You will be in there with the accounting department for the rest of the afternoon.

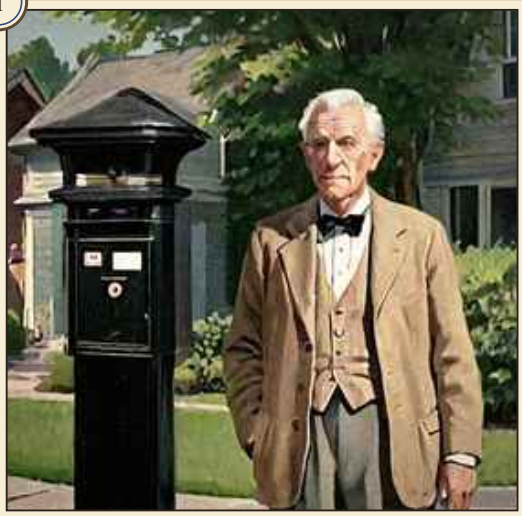
HOW TO

COLLECTING THE MAIL FROM A ZOMBIE MAILMAN

SKILL 46 · OUT AND ABOUT TOWN · 10 MINUTES · EASY

Neither rain nor snow nor gloom of night stays the mailman from his appointed rounds, and neither, it turns out, does being undead. Mr. Pruitt still delivers every letter. He simply delivers them to whoever is standing nearest.

1



Wait by the Box

Ten o'clock. Stand by the mailbox so he delivers to you, not the hedge.

2



Greet Mr. Pruitt

A wave and a 'Morning, Pruitt.' He will groan your name.

3



Accept the Letters

Hold out your hand. He will put the letters in it, very slowly.

MATERIALS


A mailbox key


Your reading glasses


A letter opener


A stamped letter to mail


A friendly wave

4



Check the Names

Half of them will be for the Hendersons. Sort them out.

5



Hand Him Your Letter

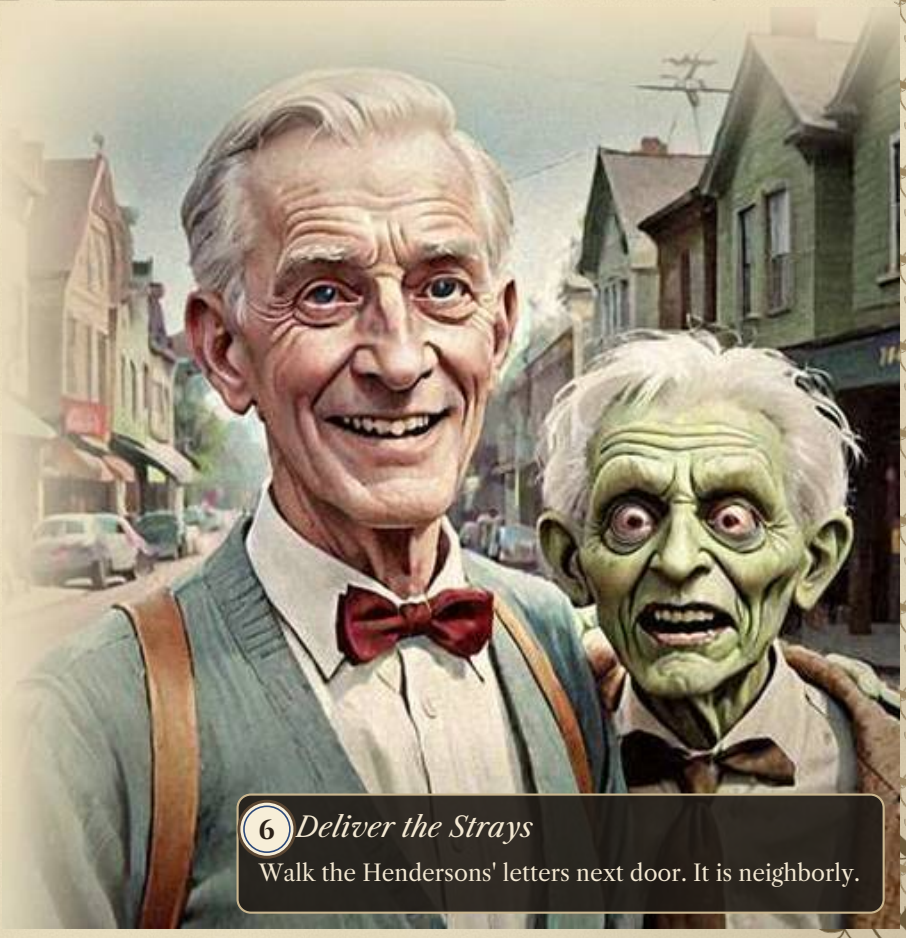
He will take it. Where it goes is between him and the Post Office.

NOTES

Put a bright red flag on your mailbox. He is drawn to bright colors and will deliver there first.

IMPORTANT

Never mail a package with a ham in it. He will not deliver it. He will sit down with it.



6 *Deliver the Strays*

Walk the Hendersons' letters next door. It is neighborly.

CHAPTER EIGHT

8

WHEN THINGS GET STICKY

Hordes on the lawn, stalled cars and uninvited guests in the kitchen







Most days, a zombie neighborhood is quiet. Slow, a little groany, but quiet. Every so often, however, something sets the whole block shuffling at once: a barbecue, a dropped pie, a man in a very bright bow tie. Then a gentleman needs a cool head, a sturdy ladder and a plan. This chapter covers the sticky situations, and how to get through them with your dignity and your hat intact.

IN THIS CHAPTER

47 When the Whole Block Is on Your Lawn

48 Climbing to the Roof With Dignity

49 When the Car Will Not Start and They Are Shuffling Closer

50 Waiting It Out in the Root Cellar With Snacks

51 Distracting the Whole Street With a Record Player

52 When One of Them Gets Into the Kitchen

53 Keeping Your Bow Tie Straight in a Panic

HOW TO

WHEN THE WHOLE BLOCK IS ON YOUR LAWN

SKILL 47 · WHEN THINGS GET STICKY · 1 EVENING · HARD

It happens to every family sooner or later. You fire up the backyard barbecue, the smell of grilling drifts down the street, and twenty minutes later the entire turned population of Elm Street is standing on your lawn. They are not angry. They are hungry, and they are very interested in the hamburgers.

1



Notice the Crowd

Look up from the grill. Count the curlers.

2



Stay Calm

A gentleman does not drop the spatula. He turns the hamburgers.

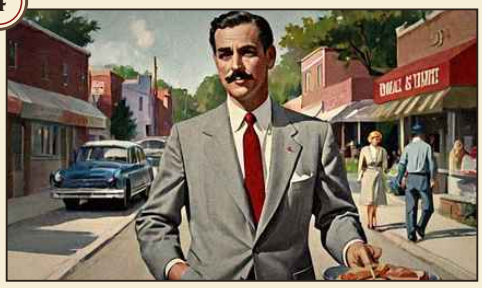
3

Offer a Hot Dog

On a long fork. The nearest one will take it and stare at it lovingly.



4



Lead Them Away

Walk slowly down the street, holding the plate of hot dogs high.

5



Leave the Plate in the Park

Set it on the picnic table and walk home briskly.

6



Finish Your Supper

Back at the grill, the burgers are just right.

NOTES

Grill with the wind blowing toward the Hendersons. They are on vacation.

IMPORTANT

Never grill liver. Not in this neighborhood.

MATERIALS

- A charcoal grill



- Two dozen hot dogs



- A long-handled fork



- A garden hose



- A calm voice



HOW TO

CLIMBING TO THE ROOF WITH DIGNITY

SKILL 48 · WHEN THINGS GET STICKY · 30 MINUTES · HARD

Sometimes the sensible place to be is on the roof. Perhaps the whole block has come to visit, perhaps the gutters need clearing. Either way, a gentleman climbs up properly, with the ladder footed and his tie tucked in, and he brings a sandwich.

MATERIALS


An extension ladder


Rubber-soled shoes


A tie clip


A sandwich in wax paper


A thermos of coffee

1



Set the Ladder Properly

One foot out for every four feet up. Check it twice.

2



Straighten Your Tie

A loose tie on a ladder is a hazard. Snug and straight.

3



Climb Steadily

Three points of contact. Do not look down at the visitors.

4



Pull Up the Ladder

Haul it onto the roof. They cannot climb, but why tempt fate.

5



Sit by the Chimney

The safest spot. Sit, unwrap your sandwich and wait.



6 *Enjoy the View*

You can see the whole street from up here. It is rather lovely.

NOTES

While you are on the roof, clear the gutters. A gentleman wastes no opportunity.

IMPORTANT

Never wave from the roof. They will all wave back, very slowly, and you will feel obliged to keep going.

WHEN THE CAR WILL NOT START AND THEY ARE SHUFFLING CLOSER

SKILL 49 · WHEN THINGS GET STICKY · 15 MINUTES · HARD

You are in the station wagon in the church parking lot. The choir practice has let out. The tenors have all turned. They are shuffling toward the car, humming. And the engine will not turn over. A gentleman does not flood the carburetor. He keeps his head.

1



Turn the Key Once

Gently. Pumping the pedal floods the engine.

2



Check the Mirror

How far away are the tenors? About forty slow feet.

3

Lock the Doors

Push down every button. Then smile through the glass.



4



Hum Along

They are humming the Doxology. Join in. It calms everyone.

5



Try the Key Again

Count to ten first. Then turn it once. It catches.

6



Drive Away Slowly

Five miles an hour. Wave goodbye to the tenors.

NOTES

Always park facing out. You never know when the choir will let out.

IMPORTANT

Never honk the horn. Every turned person within a mile will come to see what the fuss is about.

MATERIALS

- Your car keys



- A road map



- A pair of jumper cables



- A flashlight



- A hymnal (for the tenors)



HOW TO

WAITING IT OUT IN THE ROOT CELLAR WITH SNACKS

SKILL 50 · WHEN THINGS GET STICKY · 1 EVENING · MEDIUM

Sometimes the whole street gets restless at once, usually on a full moon. When that happens, the family goes down to the root cellar, and Grandmother has made sure it is the coziest root cellar in the county.

MATERIALS


A kerosene lantern


Canned peaches


Wool blankets


A deck of cards


A tin of cookies

1



Stock the Shelves

Peaches, beans, crackers and the good cookies.

2



Light the Lantern

A warm glow makes any cellar a parlor.

3



Spread the Blankets

Wool, two each. Cellars are chilly.

4



Deal a Hand of Cards

Rummy, nickel a point. Grandmother always wins.

5



Pass the Cookies

Two each, then the tin goes back on the shelf.



6 *Listen for the Quiet*

When the groaning stops, it is morning. Up you go.

NOTES

Keep a checkerboard in the cellar. A full moon lasts all night, and rummy only lasts until the children lose.

IMPORTANT

Never bring Mrs. Pettibone's fruitcake into the cellar. In an enclosed space it is overpowering.

HOW TO

DISTRACTING THE WHOLE STREET WITH A RECORD PLAYER

SKILL 51 · WHEN THINGS GET STICKY · 15 MINUTES · MEDIUM

Sally discovered it by accident: the turned neighbors cannot resist a good waltz. Put a record on the porch, turn it up, and every zombie on the street will stop whatever they were doing and sway. It is the most useful thing anyone has learned all year.

1



Carry Out the Record Player
Set it on the porch table, lid up.

2



Plug It In
The extension cord runs through the front window.

3

Choose a Waltz
The Blue Danube works best. Anything by Strauss.



4



Lower the Needle
Gently. Scratches upset them.

5



Watch Them Sway
Every zombie on the street, swaying like seaweed.

6



Slip Away Quietly
While the waltz plays, go and do what needs doing.

NOTES

Keep the record player on the porch at all times. One waltz buys you three minutes, and a long-playing record buys you twenty.

IMPORTANT

Never play rock and roll. Nobody wants to see what happens when they try to jitterbug.

MATERIALS

- A portable record player



- A stack of waltz records



- An extension cord



- A porch table



- A spare needle



HOW TO

WHEN ONE OF THEM GETS INTO THE KITCHEN

SKILL 52 · WHEN THINGS GET STICKY · 10 MINUTES · HARD

Mother turned around from the stove and there was Mrs. Pettibone, standing by the icebox, groaning gently. Someone left the back door open. A lady does not scream. She offers a chair and steers her guest firmly back out the way she came.

MATERIALS


A frying pan (for show)


A dish towel


A kitchen chair


A plate of cookies


A firm voice

1



Do Not Scream

A scream brings the whole block. A calm 'Oh, Edith!' brings nobody.

2



Pick Up the Frying Pan

Not to use. Only to feel better.

3



Greet Your Guest

'Edith, how nice. I wasn't expecting you.'

4



Offer a Cookie

Hold it out and walk backward toward the door. She will follow the cookie.

5



Guide Her Out

Through the screen door, down the steps, onto the lawn.



6 *Latch the Door*

Then put the kettle on. You have earned it.

NOTES

Keep a plate of stale cookies by the back door just for this. They cannot tell the difference.

IMPORTANT

Never chase a guest round the kitchen table. You will both be going around it until supper.

HOW TO

KEEPING YOUR BOW TIE STRAIGHT IN A PANIC

SKILL 53 · WHEN THINGS GET STICKY · 1 MINUTE · EASY

In any sticky situation, the first thing to go is a gentleman's composure, and the second is his bow tie. Keep the bow tie straight and the composure follows. It is the one piece of advice every father should give his son.

MATERIALS

- A red bow tie



- A pocket mirror



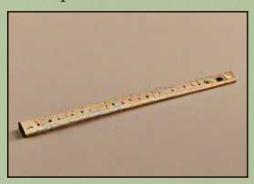
- A clean handkerchief



- A deep breath



- Good posture



1



Stop

Whatever is happening, stand still for one moment.

2



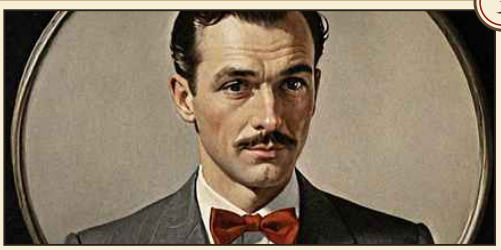
Take a Deep Breath

In through the nose, out through the mustache.

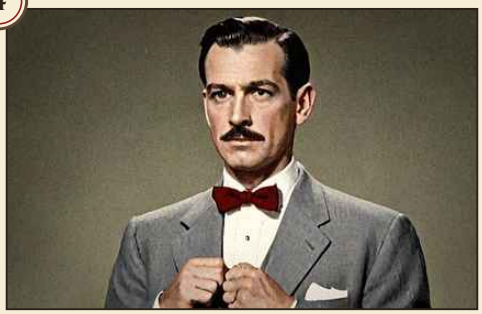
3

Check the Pocket Mirror

Is the bow tie crooked? Of course it is.



4



Straighten It

Both wings level. A little tug on each side.

5



Mop Your Brow

A clean handkerchief, folded, dabbed. Never wiped.

6



Carry On

Now deal with the zombies. You will find it much easier.

NOTES

A clip-on bow tie is acceptable in an emergency. Only in an emergency.

IMPORTANT

Never take your tie off in front of the undead. They will think it is something to eat.

CHAPTER NINE

9

ONE BIG HAPPY BLOCK

Block parties, holidays and living happily alongside the turned







Here is the secret nobody tells you: a zombie neighborhood can be a very happy neighborhood. The turned folks are loyal, patient and never late. They love a party, adore a parade and will stand at your fence every evening just to keep you company. This last chapter is about bringing the whole block together, the living and the less so, for block parties, holidays and the simple pleasure of a good neighbor.

IN THIS CHAPTER

54 Throwing a Block Party for Everybody
55 Welcoming the Newly Turned to the Neighborhood
56 Halloween on a Street That Is Already Spooky
57 Thanksgiving With the Hales
58 Teaching a Zombie to Dance the Fox-Trot
59 Christmas Carols With a Choir That Only Moans
60 Being the Best Gentleman on the Block

HOW TO

THROWING A BLOCK PARTY FOR EVERYBODY

SKILL 54 · ONE BIG HAPPY BLOCK · 1 DAY · HARD

Once a summer, Elm Street closes to traffic and holds a block party. This year it is for everybody: the living, the turned and the Hendersons, who are still deciding which they are. Mother is in charge, as usual.

1



Hang the Bunting
Red, white and blue, from porch to porch.

2



Set Out the Tables
Down the middle of the street, end to end.

3



Fill Them With Food
Pies, casseroles, Jell-O and a great deal of cauliflower.

MATERIALS


Long folding tables


Paper lanterns


Bunting


Pies (many)


A record player

4



Welcome the Turned Guests
They come early. They always come early.

5



Light the Lanterns
At dusk, one by one, all the way down the street.

NOTES

Put the cauliflower at one end and the hot dogs at the other. The two crowds keep each other moving.

IMPORTANT

Do not hold a pie-eating contest. The turned contestants will not stop when the pies run out.



6 *Start the Waltz*
Put on a record. Everyone sways. Everyone.

HOW TO

WELCOMING THE NEWLY TURNED TO THE NEIGHBORHOOD

SKILL 55 · ONE BIG HAPPY BLOCK · 1 HOUR · MEDIUM

MATERIALS

- A wicker basket



- A loaf of banana bread



- A head of cauliflower



- A map of the block



- A welcome card



When a neighbor turns, the Welcome Wagon calls. It is the decent thing to do. They are going through a big change, they may be confused, and they would very much like a basket of something.

1



Fill the Basket

Banana bread, a head of cauliflower and a little map of the block.

2



Put On Your Hat

A Welcome Wagon call is an occasion.

3

Ring the Bell

Once, and wait. They take a while to reach the door.



4



Hand Over the Basket

With a warm smile and 'Welcome to the turned side of Elm Street!'

5



Explain the Basics

Point to the map. 'This is your house. This is our house. Please use the gate.'

6



Invite Them to Church

Third pew on the left. Plenty of room.

NOTES

Write the family's own address on the back of the welcome card and tuck it in his jacket. It saves him a lot of wandering.

IMPORTANT

Do not bring flowers. The newly turned eat them, and then they feel embarrassed.

HOW TO

HALLOWEEN ON A STREET THAT IS ALREADY SPOOKY

SKILL 56 · ONE BIG HAPPY BLOCK · 1 EVENING · EASY

Halloween on Elm Street used to be quiet. Now it is the most popular night of the year. The turned neighbors adore it. They think everyone has finally come round to their way of thinking, and they join every trick-or-treat line on the block.

1



Carve the Pumpkin

A friendly face. Nothing scary. The neighbors are sensitive.

2



Put On Your Costume

Junior is a cowboy. A sensible choice.

3



Light the Jack-o'-Lantern

On the porch step, candle inside.

MATERIALS


A homemade costume


A pillowcase for candy


A flashlight


A carved jack-o'-lantern


A list of houses

4



Trick or Treat

Up the walk, ring the bell, say it nicely.

5



Notice Who Is in Line

The fellow behind you with no costume is Mr. Hale. Let him go first.

NOTES

The turned neighbors make excellent Halloween decorations. Ask them to stand on your lawn. They are happy to help.

IMPORTANT

Never dress up as a zombie. It confuses everyone, and Mrs. Pettibone will try to take you home.



6 *Share the Candy*

Back home, sort it on the rug. Give Mr. Hale the candy corn. Nobody else wants it.

HOW TO

THANKSGIVING WITH THE HALES

SKILL 57 · ONE BIG HAPPY BLOCK · 1 DAY · HARD

MATERIALS

- A roast turkey



- A carving knife



- Cranberry sauce



- A cauliflower (for Mr. Hale)



- Extra chairs



The Hales have come for Thanksgiving every year since 1949. Mr. Hale has turned and Mrs. Hale has not, but she says he still enjoys the company. Father carves, Mother serves, and Mr. Hale sits at the end of the table with a napkin in his collar, groaning gratefully.

1



Add the Leaves to the Table

Both leaves in. Thanksgiving needs room.

2



Sharpen the Carving Knife

A gentleman carves with a sharp knife and a steady hand.

3

Carry In the Turkey

On the big platter, to applause.



4



Carve at the Table

White meat on the left, dark on the right.

5



Serve Mr. Hale His Cauliflower

A whole one, with cheese sauce. He groans with joy.

6



Say What You Are Thankful For

Around the table. Mr. Hale goes last and groans the longest.

NOTES

Seat Mr. Hale next to the pumpkin pie. He will not eat it, but he guards it beautifully until dessert.

IMPORTANT

Never ask a turned guest to pull the wishbone. He will not let go, and nobody gets a wish.

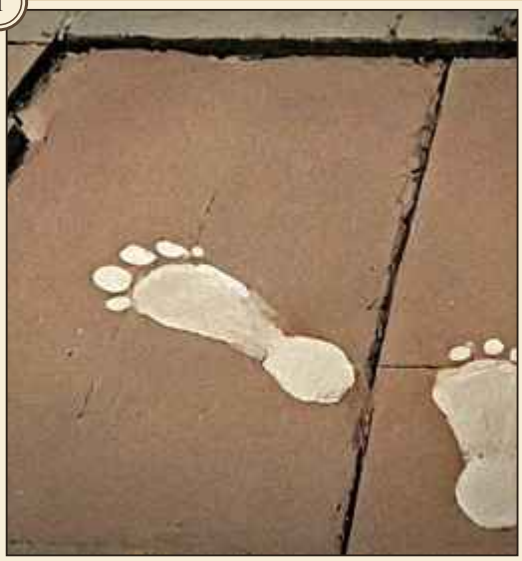
HOW TO

TEACHING A ZOMBIE TO DANCE THE FOX-TROT

SKILL 58 · ONE BIG HAPPY BLOCK · 1 EVENING · MEDIUM

The turned neighbors love to sway. Sally has decided that swaying is halfway to dancing, and she has started teaching Mr. Hale the fox-trot for the block party. It is slow, slow, quick-quick. The quick-quick needs work.

1



Chalk the Footprints

Big chalk footprints on the patio. Slow, slow, quick-quick.

2



Put On the Record

Something slow. Glenn Miller.

3



Show Him the Steps

Walk it alone first. Count out loud.

MATERIALS



A record player



A fox-trot record



Chalk for footprints



A clear patio



Patience

4



Let Him Try

Slow. Slow. Slow. Slow. That is close enough.

5



Clap for Him

Every step deserves applause.

NOTES

Turned dancers never step on your toes. They never lift their feet high enough.

IMPORTANT

Never try to dip a zombie. Nobody knows how to get them back up.



6 *Practice Every Evening*

By the block party he will do the slow part beautifully.

HOW TO

CHRISTMAS CAROLS WITH A CHOIR THAT ONLY MOANS

SKILL 59 · ONE BIG HAPPY BLOCK · 1 EVENING · EASY

MATERIALS

- A song sheet



- A lantern



- Warm mittens



- A thermos of cocoa

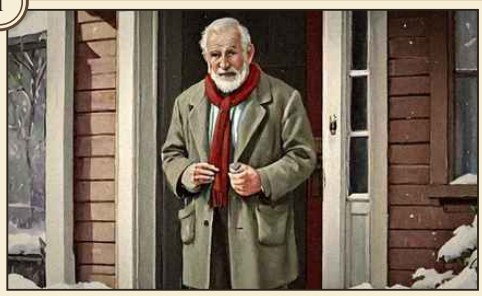


- A scarf



The Elm Street carolers have gone door to door every Christmas Eve since Grandfather was a boy. This year half the choir has turned. They cannot remember the words, but they moan the tunes with real feeling, and the result is, Grandfather says, 'very moving'.

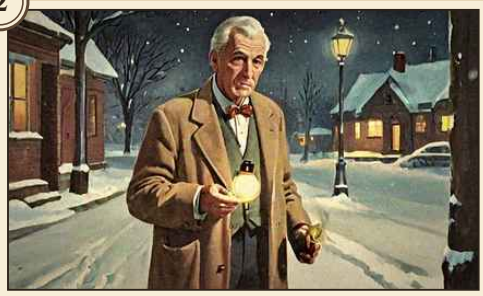
1



Bundle Up

Scarf, mittens, overcoat. It is December.

2



Light the Lantern

Carolers carry a lantern. It is tradition.

3

Gather the Choir

The living in front with the song sheets. The rest behind, moaning.



4



Sing at Every Door

'Silent Night' works best. They already have the moaning part.

5



Accept the Cocoa

Every house offers cocoa. Accept it. Hold it for the ones who cannot.

6



Walk Everyone Home

The turned carolers will follow the lantern. Lead them to their doors.

NOTES

Choose carols with lots of 'ooh' in them. The turned choir members are very good at 'ooh'.

IMPORTANT

Never sing 'Here We Come A-Wassailing'. They take it literally.

HOW TO

BEING THE BEST GENTLEMAN ON THE BLOCK

SKILL 60 · ONE BIG HAPPY BLOCK · A LIFETIME · HARD

In the end, it all comes down to this. A gentleman is kind to his neighbors, all of them. He keeps his lawn neat, his shoes shined, his bow tie straight and his manners intact, whatever is shuffling past. He is, quite simply, the best neighbor on the street.

1



Rise Early
Up at six, shaved by quarter past.

2



Greet Everyone by Name
The living, the turned and the undecided.

3



Lend a Hand
Carry the groceries, return the mower, fetch the bottles off the roof.

MATERIALS


A pressed suit


A straight bow tie


A neat lawn


A kind word


A wave for everyone

4



Keep Your Lawn Fine
A good lawn says a good man lives here.

5



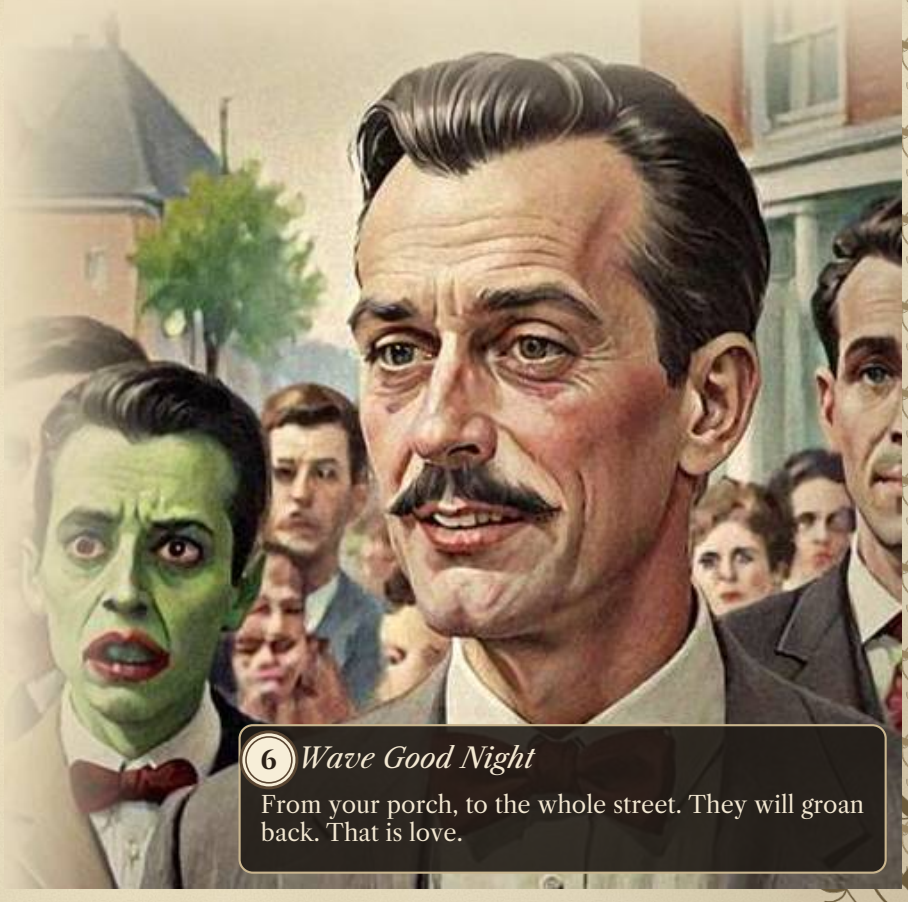
Sit With Mr. Hale
Once a week, on his porch, for a quiet half hour.

NOTES

A gentleman is judged by how he treats those who can do nothing for him. On Elm Street, that is about half the block.

IMPORTANT

There is no caution here. Be kind, and keep your hat on.



6 *Wave Good Night*
From your porch, to the whole street. They will groan back. That is love.

APPENDIX

Charts, checklists and quick references

A. FIELD GUIDE TO THE NEIGHBORS

Who you are likely to meet, where to find them and how to address them. When in doubt, tip your hat.

NEIGHBOR	WHERE FOUND	LOOKS LIKE	FOND OF	ADDRESS AS
Mr. Hale	Next door, in the hedge	Brown suit, since April	Cauliflower, the Dodgers	Mr. Hale
Mrs. Pettibone	Your porch swing	Pink curlers, housecoat	Sugar, yarn, fruitcake	Edith, dear
Mr. Doyle (milkman)	The wrong porch, at six	White cap, wire basket	His route	Mr. Doyle
Mr. Pruitt (mailman)	Whoever is nearest	Blue cap, heavy bag	Hams in parcels	Mr. Pruitt
Tommy Briggs	The end of the walk	Newsboy cap, strong arm	Pillows, dimes	Tommy
Gus the barber	Main Street	White coat, clippers	The shave (decline)	Gus
The foursome	Sand trap, 7th hole	Plaid trousers	The pond	Fellows
Fifi	The Hales' porch	Green poodle	Rusty, sitting	Good girl
Miss Gertie Plum	The corner, standing	Babysitter	Bedtimes	Miss Plum

B. WHAT TO SERVE WHOM

A hostess's chart for every guest on the street: what to serve, what to think twice about, what never to serve and how long they will stay.

GUEST	SERVE	MAYBE	NEVER SERVE	WILL STAY UNTIL
Mr. Hale	Cauliflower, cheese sauce	Mashed potatoes	Shrimp cocktail	Midnight
Mrs. Pettibone	Finger sandwiches	Brown sugar	Scented anything	Easter
The milkman	Nothing (he is working)	A tip	Cottage cheese	Six fifteen
The bridge club	Cucumber sandwiches	Nuts	The score pad	Ten sharp
The horde	Hot dogs (to go)	Lemonade	Liver	The hot dogs run out
Fifi	A bowl of her own	A biscuit	A stick	Next Thursday
The turned choir	Hot cocoa (to hold)	Fruitcake	Wassail	The last verse

C. CHECKLISTS

Copy these pages and tick items off as you get ready. Check the cauliflower and the waltz records every week.

THE GENTLEMAN'S NEIGHBORHOOD KIT

- ☐ A pressed suit and a spare bow tie
- ☐ A pocket mirror
- ☐ A gray fedora
- ☐ A push mower (never electric)
- ☐ A long-handled broom
- ☐ A baseball glove
- ☐ Two heads of cauliflower
- ☐ A portable record player
- ☐ A plate of stale cookies
- ☐ An extension ladder
- ☐ A kerosene lantern
- ☐ A kind word for everyone

BEFORE THE POTLUCK

- ☐ Casserole labeled with your name
- ☐ Parsley on top
- ☐ Cauliflower in cheese sauce
- ☐ Seating chart drawn
- ☐ Place cards written
- ☐ Coasters out
- ☐ Pie ready for leading guests home
- ☐ Lights to switch off one by one
- ☐ Your hat and coat by the door

FOR A HAPPY BLOCK PARTY

- ☐ Bunting from porch to porch
- ☐ Tables down the middle of the street
- ☐ Cauliflower at one end
- ☐ Hot dogs at the other
- ☐ Paper lanterns
- ☐ Waltz records (no rock and roll)
- ☐ Lemonade for the living
- ☐ Cups for the turned to hold
- ☐ A chair for Mr. Hale
- ☐ Wave to everyone

D. HOUSEHOLD REMEDIES FOR NEIGHBORLY MISHAPS

Every turned neighbor causes a little bother sooner or later. Here is what to do, calmly, with your bow tie straight.

MISHAP	REMEDY	NOTES
Neighbor stuck in the hedge	Ease him out backward	Leave a doorway next time
Milk on the wrong porch	Fetch it in your slippers	And leave a clear note
Zombie in the petunias	Take her by the elbow	Then replant
Guests will not leave	Lead them out with pie	Start clearing at half past eight
Gravy spilled	Linen napkin and a smile	Pour it yourself next time
Whole block on the lawn	A plate of hot dogs, walked away	Grill downwind
Car will not start	Count to ten, turn the key once	And hum along
Mrs. Pettibone in the kitchen	A cookie, walked backward	Latch the screen door
Crooked bow tie	Pocket mirror, two tugs	Composure follows
Knitting circle tangle	Unwind patiently	Give her the big needles
Lopsided haircut	A good fedora	Just a trim next time
Fruitcake (any)	Thin slices, sealed tin	Keeps for eleven years

E. HANDY NEIGHBORHOOD CONVERSIONS

MEASURE	ROUGHLY EQUALS
1 groan, going down	A sleepy neighbor
1 groan, going up	A turned neighbor
1 'Braaains'	Good morning
1 head of cauliflower	1 very happy dinner guest
1 waltz on the porch	3 minutes of peace
1 long-playing record	20 minutes of peace
1 cup of sugar (lent)	Never returned
1 zombie on the lawn	1 excellent sundial
1 hat-tip	1 slow 'Good day'
1 fruitcake	11 years of storage
1 bow tie, straightened	1 gentleman, composed

F. HOUSEHOLD NEIGHBORHOOD CARD

Fill this in together and pin a copy by the telephone and inside the root cellar door.

Household name	
Date the first neighbor turned	
Turned houses on our street (count)	
Cauliflower is kept in	
Waltz records are kept in	
Spare bow tie is kept in	
Extension ladder is kept in	
Root cellar key is kept in	
Mrs. Pettibone's sugar tally	
Next Yard of the Month judging	
Next block party	
Never serve	

IMPORTANT NUMBERS

Emergency	911
The doctor	
Father's office	
Grandmother	
The Garden Club	
First Methodist (the Reverend)	
Neighbor (living)	
Neighbor (turned, for Mrs. Hale)	

G. GLOSSARY

Braaains. A zombie greeting. Usually means 'Good morning'. Sometimes means 'Cream today?'

Cauliflower. Brains, for all practical purposes. Twelve cents a head.

Fox-trot. Slow, slow, quick-quick. The turned manage the slow part beautifully.

Fruitcake. A gift that lasts. And lasts.

Gentleman. A man who is kind to everyone, including those who groan.

Groan, rising. A sign of a turned neighbor. Compare with the falling groan of Monday.

Hat-tip. The gentleman's handshake. Two fingers, one inch, a small nod.

Hedge. Where Mr. Hale spends his evenings.

Horde. The whole block at once. Usually means someone is grilling.

Jell-O. A dessert the turned believe to be alive. They may be right.

Root cellar. The coziest room in the house on a full moon.

Shuffle. The way the turned walk. Not to be confused with Monday.

Sundial. A zombie standing still on a lawn. Accurate to the quarter hour.

Turned. The polite word. Never 'gone green'.

Waltz. The surest way to calm a street. Strauss is best.

Welcome Wagon. The ladies who call on new neighbors, including the newly turned.

Yard of the Month. The highest honor on Elm Street. Judged by three ladies, two of them turned.

Zombie. A neighbor who has turned. Still a neighbor.

H. WHERE TO LEARN MORE

- **Etiquette:** your public library has excellent books on manners. They do not mention zombies, but the principles hold.
- **Lawn and garden:** the county extension office, the Garden Club and Grandmother, who has won the petunia ribbon three years running.
- **Cookery:** Mother's recipe box, the church cookbook and any recipe that starts with a can of mushroom soup.
- **Staying calm:** a cup of tea, a straight bow tie and a slow waltz on the porch.
- **Good neighbors:** the folks next door, whatever color they are this week. Go and say hello.

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MY SKILLS LOG

Tick off each skill once your household has done it. Do not let Mr. Hale tick them for you. He uses a crayon.

#	SKILL	DATE TRIED	DONE
01	Noticing That Mr. Hale Has Turned		☐
02	The Milkman Who Only Says 'Brains'		☐
03	Telling a Zombie From a Neighbor Before Coffee		☐
04	When the Bridge Club Comes Back Different		☐
05	Taking the Morning Paper From a Zombie Paperboy		☐
06	Breaking the News to the Family Over Supper		☐
07	Mowing Around a Zombie Who Will Not Move		☐
08	Keeping Zombies Off the Petunias		☐
09	Trimming the Hedge When Someone Is Stuck in It		☐
10	Sprinkler Etiquette for the Shambling		☐
11	Raking Leaves With Help You Did Not Ask For		☐
12	Winning Yard of the Month Anyway		☐
13	Fixing the Picket Fence (Again)		☐
14	Dressing Sharp When the Whole Block Is Rumpled		☐
15	Shining Your Shoes for a World That Drags Its Feet		☐
16	Hosting Bridge When One Guest Is Undead		☐
17	The Front Porch Must Always Look Welcoming		☐
18	Tipping Your Hat to a Neighbor Who Groans Back		☐
19	Washing the Station Wagon With Spectators		☐
20	Explaining the Neighbors to Visiting Relatives		☐
21	Bringing a Casserole to a Zombie Potluck		☐
22	Serving Cauliflower and Calling It Brains		☐
23	Seating Chart for the Living and the Less So		☐
24	Saying Grace Over the Groaning		☐
25	Passing the Gravy to a Zombie		☐
26	The Jell-O Mold That Wobbled Back		☐
27	Clearing the Table When the Guests Will Not Leave		☐
28	Lending a Cup of Sugar Over the Fence		☐
29	Accepting a Fruitcake From the Undead		☐
30	Making Small Talk With a Groaner		☐
31	Returning a Borrowed Lawn Mower		☐
32	Gossip Over the Clothesline		☐
33	Writing a Thank-You Note They Cannot Read		☐
34	Teaching the Children to Say 'Good Morning, Mr. Hale'		☐
35	When the Dog Brings Home a Zombie Poodle		☐
36	Running a Lemonade Stand on a Slow-Moving Street		☐
37	Grandmother's Knitting Circle Gets a New Member		☐
38	Hide and Seek Rules for the Whole Block		☐

#	SKILL	DATE TRIED	DONE
39	Interviewing a Babysitter Who Shuffles		☐
40	Church on Sunday, Groans in the Pew		☐
41	Getting a Haircut From a Zombie Barber		☐
42	Grocery Shopping When the Aisles Are Slow		☐
43	Bowling Night With a Team That Will Not Hurry		☐
44	A Round of Golf With the Undead Foursome		☐
45	Riding the Office Elevator With the Undead		☐
46	Collecting the Mail From a Zombie Mailman		☐
47	When the Whole Block Is on Your Lawn		☐
48	Climbing to the Roof With Dignity		☐
49	When the Car Will Not Start and They Are Shuffling Closer		☐
50	Waiting It Out in the Root Cellar With Snacks		☐
51	Distracting the Whole Street With a Record Player		☐
52	When One of Them Gets Into the Kitchen		☐
53	Keeping Your Bow Tie Straight in a Panic		☐
54	Throwing a Block Party for Everybody		☐
55	Welcoming the Newly Turned to the Neighborhood		☐
56	Halloween on a Street That Is Already Spooky		☐
57	Thanksgiving With the Hales		☐
58	Teaching a Zombie to Dance the Fox-Trot		☐
59	Christmas Carols With a Choir That Only Moans		☐
60	Being the Best Gentleman on the Block		☐

NOTES

Neighbors greeted, casseroles brought, hedges cleared, and every hat you have tipped.

THE BOOK EVERY SENSIBLE FAMILY NEEDS

It started with Mr. Hale next door walking into the hedge. Then the milkman began leaving the bottles on the wrong porch, the bridge club came back from the church social a little green and the whole block turned up on the lawn the moment Father lit the barbecue. Half the street has turned. Somebody had better keep up appearances.

The Gentleman's Guide to the Zombie Neighborhood is here to help: sixty sensible skills, each laid out on a single page with a picture for every step, a materials panel and notes on what can go wrong. Tabs on every page help you find what you need, even while Mrs. Pettibone is asleep on your porch swing.

INSIDE YOU WILL LEARN HOW TO

- Mow around a zombie who will not move
- Get a neighbor out of the hedge
- Serve cauliflower and call it brains
- Pass the gravy to the undead
- Tip your hat to a groaner
- Survive the zombie barber
- Calm a street with a waltz
- Lead the whole block home with pie
- Win Yard of the Month anyway
- Keep your bow tie straight



"Good fences make good neighbors. Good manners make the rest."
OLD HOUSEHOLD SAYING

THE GENTLEMAN'S GUIDE TO THE ZOMBIE NEIGHBORHOOD
Household / Neighbors / Humor

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